

ATHLOS

Marketing System

The founder-led operating manual

HOW WE BUILD OUR ENTIRE DIGITAL PRESENCE — FROM THE GROUND UP

Ian Veber is the face. This is the machine we build around him.

Operating manual v1 · July 2026 · internal — for the ATHLOS team

Method: the Iman Gadzhi model, adapted honestly for a cold start.

What this is

This is the single document the whole team builds the marketing machine from. It is not strategy theory — it is a build spec. By the end, every person knows what to set up, what we film, exactly how we film it, how the funnels work, and how the team runs the whole thing week to week.

The one idea underneath everything: a personal brand is a *machine that turns attention into revenue*. Ian is the face and the trust engine — that part cannot be outsourced. Everything else (the kit, the edit, the funnels, the ops) the team builds around him so his on-camera job stays small and repeatable. We optimize for **leads, not views**.

How to read it: Chapters 1–3 are what you build and film. Chapter 4 is where it goes. Chapter 5 is the money machine behind it. Chapter 6 is how the team runs all of it. Read your chapter deeply; skim the rest so you know how your part connects.

The locked context (don't re-debate these)

- **Who we sell to first:** young Slovenian football (nogomet) + basketball (košarka) athletes, 16–26, who want to be faster and more explosive. Niche hard — not “all athletes.”
- **The offer:** first 100 members lock their price for life. BASIC €29 · PRO ★ €59 · ELITE €89 / month.
- **The dual brand:** Ian's personal account = trust engine → the @athlos account = conversion surface → Beehiiv list → Stripe checkout. Organic only, Slovenia-first, MVP launches to the warm list in ~30 days.

- **The honest target:** plan emotionally for **5 founding members, be thrilled at 15**. The real asset we build is a warm list of the right athletes + a working machine + our first testimonials. Do not measure this against anyone's highlight reel.

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1 • The Model & The Ground-Up Setup

This is Chapter 1 of the **ATHLOS Marketing System** — the single operating manual the whole team builds the machine from. Manual text is in English (our working language). Every actual content asset — bios, handles, captions, pinned copy, CTAs — is in native Slovenian, exactly as it will ship. Read this before anyone films, posts, or wires up a single tool.

1.1 The model in plain terms

HOW THE IMAN MODEL ACTUALLY WORKS

Strip away the villa and the screenshots and Iman Gadzhi's marketing runs on four load-bearing ideas. We steal the mechanics, not the persona.

1. **A brand is a machine that turns attention into revenue.** Not a vibe, not a follower count — a *machine* with an input (a stranger's attention) and an output (a paying member). The **Intentional Brand** principle: you map the path from *someone watching* to *someone buying* **before** you make anything. If a piece of content has no path to the offer, you either know it's a nurture piece and post it on purpose, or you don't make it.
2. **Content is a compounding owned asset, not a treadmill.** You are not a content creator posting to survive the algorithm; you are a business owner building "digital real estate" that keeps selling while you sleep. A video filmed once and packaged well keeps working for years. That reframe is what makes the whole thing sustainable for a founder who also has a product to ship.
3. **Optimize for LEADS, not views.** This is the discipline that separates a business from an influencer. A 5,000-follower brand can out-earn a 5,000,000-follower one because it measures the right thing. The first question on every content idea is: *is the goal views, or leads?* View counts are dopamine; leads are money. We ban vanity metrics from our scoreboard (Chapter 1.4 and the metrics section make this concrete).
4. **The founder's face is the non-delegable engine.** People follow a *person*, not a logo they've never heard of. The trust that makes a stranger buy comes from a human being on camera — their story, their opinions, their face. You can delegate editing, scheduling, thumbnails, email setup, analytics, and DMs. You **cannot** delegate being the face. That is the one job that has to stay with the founder.

HOW ATHLOS RUNS IT THE SAME WAY — WITH IAN AS THE FACE

Everything above transfers directly, with one hard adaptation: **we are a cold start** (near-zero audience, a founder who's also shipping the app, a warm list you can count on two hands, a ~2.1M-person Slovenian market, organic-only, ~30 days to MVP). So we invert Iman's default: he optimizes reach-first because he can monetize later at scale; **we optimize warm-list-and-depth first, and treat reach as the slow second engine.** (This blind-spot check runs through the whole manual — never assume Iman's scale.)

The central mandate: Ian Veber is THE FACE. Ian films the content, Ian is *in* the content, Ian presents on camera. He is the founder-athlete building the AI training system he wished existed — documenting the whole thing (THE JOURNEY) while training himself on it, in public, in Slovenian. That building-in-public is un-copyable because it's literally his life for the next 30+ days. The entire system in this manual is designed so **Ian can be the on-camera talent while the team builds and runs the machine around him.** Tim Drenovc (physiologist) is the science-credibility face — the proof, not the promoter — appearing lightly where the science needs a real authority behind it.

HOW THE MACHINE WORKS (THE ONE DIAGRAM, IN WORDS)

Read this left to right. It is the whole business on one line, and every later chapter is a zoom-in on one arrow.

IAN'S FACE	→	CONTENT	→	LEAD	→	NURTURE	→	OFFER	→	MEMBER
(trust engine – the founder on camera)		(reverse-engineered from ONE CTA, not for views)		(owned email on the Beehiiv list)		(Beehiiv emails + the VSL build trust)		(first 100 lock price for life)		(paying founding athlete, retained month 2+)

- **Ian's face** → **content.** Ian is the reason a stranger stops scrolling. Everything starts with him on camera. The content isn't made "for content's sake" — each piece is reverse-engineered from one call-to-action (the free Tim plan / the waitlist).
- **Content** → **lead.** The content points at one thing: the free lead magnet. A follower is rented from the algorithm; a **lead is an owned email on the Beehiiv list.** We convert followers into emails as fast as possible, because we own the email and only rent the follow.
- **Lead** → **nurture.** The Beehiiv list gets a Slovenian story sequence + the core video (VSL). This is where trust in Ian *and* Tim is built. At our scale the warm list is not a footnote — **it is the launch.**
- **Nurture** → **offer.** The first-100 early-bird (BASIC €29 / PRO ★ €59 / ELITE €89, lock price for life) opens to the warm list first. Real, modest scarcity — never a fake counter.

- **Offer → member.** Stripe checkout, then activation and retention. The subscription profit lives in month 2+, so a member isn't "won" at checkout — they're won when they're still here next month.

The one-sentence version: *Ian's face pulls a stranger in → content routes them to a free Tim plan → that turns them into an owned email → 30 days of Slovenian nurture warms them → the first-100 offer converts them → onboarding and retention keep them paying.* No step depends on volume we don't have. Every step depends on catching leads a single human can still handle by hand.

1.2 The non-negotiable principles

These are the rules the whole team operates by. If a decision is unclear, it resolves in favor of these. Print them; they govern every chapter that follows.

1. **Ian is the face. Full stop.** No piece of top-of-funnel content ships without Ian on camera or in voice. We build the machine *around* the founder; we never try to replace him with a logo, a faceless page, or AI voiceover. This is the one non-delegable job. (*Iman: the founder's face is the engine.*)
2. **Leads, not views.** We measure confirmed Beehiiv leads and paying members — never follower count, never Reel views. Anyone who catches themselves celebrating a view count is off-mission. (*Iman: Optimize-for-leads-not-views.*)
3. **Every piece has a path to the offer — or we know it's nurture.** Before we make anything, we map the click-path: content → link-in-bio → free plan → list → offer. If a piece has no path, it's a deliberate nurture/relationship piece for the core, and we label it as such. No "just vibes" posts by accident. (*Iman: Intentional Brand.*)
4. **The warm list is the launch, not a footnote.** The Beehiiv list is the highest-priority asset in the business. We over-index on emailing it, we plug every leak in it, and we give it first crack at the first 100 spots. Reach is the slow second engine; the list is the launch. (*Iman inverted for cold start: No-Leak Backend + warm-list-first.*)
5. **One niche, owned completely, first.** Young Slovenian **football (nogomet) + basketball (košarka)** athletes, 16–26, speed & explosiveness. The enemy is generic bodybuilding splits. We do not say "for all athletes." We earn the right to expand by winning this segment first. (*Iman: Niche-Down-Then-Expand.*)

6. **Manual where it converts, automated where it plumbs.** At a few hundred leads, a personal DM out-converts any automated flow. We automate the plumbing (Beehiiv sequence, Stripe, abandonment, dunning) and we do the *closing* by hand. Ian talks to every lead — that’s the unfair advantage a big operator has lost. (*Iman: adapted — he automates because of volume; we go manual because we can.*)
 7. **Packaging is 80%.** The big idea + title + thumbnail + hook decide whether content is ever seen. We decide title and thumbnail *before* filming, not after. Thumbnails are engineering (CTR), not art. (*Iman: Packaging = 80%.*)
 8. **Scarcity and claims stay honest.** Real, modest scarcity only — “prvih 100, cena zaklenjena za vedno” is true and enough. In a small market where everyone knows everyone, one whiff of a fake counter is permanent trust death. We never fake a number. (*Iman inverted: no scarcity theater.*)
 9. **Disqualify openly.** We state clearly who ATHLOS is *not* for. It raises perceived value for free and filters the tire-kickers a solo founder can’t afford to babysit in the DMs. (*Iman: Disqualification.*)
 10. **Documentation over production.** Ian doesn’t need studio gear or to be the world’s best trainer (Tim covers the science). He needs to be one step ahead and radically transparent about building ATHLOS. Good audio + clean background + honesty beats a fancy edit. (*Iman: documentation-before-education.*)
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1.3 THE GROUND-UP SETUP CHECKLIST

Everything below stands up **before** we film a single thing. Assign an owner to each block, tick the boxes, and don’t start Week 1 content until Section A (accounts) and Section B (tech) are green. This is a real checklist — execute it top to bottom.

A. THE TWO ACCOUNTS

Two accounts, two jobs, one flywheel — they interlock, they don’t compete. **Attention only flows Ian → ATHLOS → sale.** Ian’s account is the priority (~80% of effort); the @athlos account launches lean (~20%) as a proof-and-offer repository.

A1 — Ian Veber (personal) — the TRUST ENGINE

- ☐ **Instagram handle:** @ian.veber (fallback @ianveber / @ian.veber.athlos if taken). Real name, not a brand alias — people follow a person.

- ☐ **YouTube channel:** Ian Veber (custom URL @ianveber). This is where the core converting long-form (the VSL) lives — the buyer must trust the founder-athlete before the app.
- ☐ **Profile photo (both):** the same clean, well-lit portrait of Ian's face on both platforms — recognizable at thumbnail size, consistent across every surface. Face fills the frame; neutral or on-brand background.
- ☐ **YouTube channel art / banner:** simple. Ian's face + one line of positioning + “novo vsak teden.” Hellenic accent only (see brand kit) — do not clutter it.
- ☐ **Instagram bio (Slovenian) — drop-in:**

Ian Veber Gradim ATHLOS — športna ekipa velikih klubov, zdaj v tvojem žepu 🏠
 Nogomet & košarka · hitrost & eksplozivnost Vse treniram na sebi, pred kamero. Dan po dnevu. 📌 Brezplačen 7-dnevni načrt za tvoj šport (*link-in-bio*)

- ☐ **YouTube channel description (Slovenian) — drop-in:**

Sem Ian. Gradim ATHLOS — sistem, ki vsakemu športniku da strokovno ekipo, ki jo imajo samo veliki klubi. In vse skupaj treniram na sebi, pred kamero. Tu dokumentiram gradnjo: športna znanost (s fiziologom Timom Drenovcem), pravi treningi, resnica o tem, kako postaneš hitrejši in eksplozivnejši. Če treniraš nogomet ali košarko in ti je dost generičnih programov — si na pravem mestu. 📌 Brezplačen 7-dnevni načrt za tvoj šport

- ☐ **Link-in-bio structure** (see D2 below) — top link always = the free Tim plan opt-in.
- ☐ **Pinned content:** as soon as it exists, pin THE JOURNEY “Dan 1 / 30” piece on IG and the core VSL on YouTube. Until then, pin the best available intro-to-Ian piece.

A2 — @athlos (app account) — the CONVERSION SURFACE

- ☐ **Instagram handle:** @athlos.app (fallback @athlos.si / @athlos.trening). Lock the same base name on YouTube.
- ☐ **YouTube channel:** ATHLOS (custom URL @athlos). Lean — a link-and-proof repository, ~2x/week, not a second content machine.
- ☐ **Profile photo (both):** the ATHLOS logo/mark on the Hellenic palette (marble white bg, ink/gold mark). Crisp at small size.
- ☐ **Channel art / banner:** the ATHLOS wordmark + one-liner + the offer tease. Clean, mythic-athlete look.

- ☐ **Instagram bio (Slovenian) — drop-in:**

ATHLOS 🏠 Atletski operacijski sistem. Treniraj kot heroj, ne kot povprečje. Strokovna ekipa velikih klubov — v tvojem žepu, v slovenščini. Nogomet · košarka · hitrost & ek-splzivnost 📌 Prvih 100 zaklene ceno za vedno (*link-in-bio*)

- ☐ **YouTube channel description (Slovenian) — drop-in:**

ATHLOS — atletski operacijski sistem. AI-personaliziran trening za športnike, zgrajen okoli tvojega športa in tvoje sezone. Znanost: fiziolog Tim Drenovc. Zgrajeno v Sloveniji, v slovenščini. Treniraj kot heroj, ne kot povprečje. 📌 Vstopi med prvih 100

- ☐ **Link-in-bio:** points to the waitlist / offer (post-launch: checkout).
- ☐ **Pinned content:** the offer/first-100 explainer, or a Tim science proof piece.

Cold-start rule for both accounts: short-form is **filmed once and cross-posted to both** (and to YouTube Shorts). We do not run two content machines. Revisit separation only after the personal account has real traction, post-launch.

B. THE TECH STACK

Stand this up before content, because at 40–200 leads every leak is a countable buyer. One owner per tool.

- ☐ **Beehiiv** — the email/list home. Confirm double-opt-in behavior and wire the **confirmation-nudge** (the #1 silent leak: sign-ups stuck “pending” who never get an email). Set up the re-engagement, nurture, and launch sequences (Chapter on funnel). From-name = “Ilan iz ATHLOS-a,” reply-to a real inbox Ilan reads.
- ☐ **Stripe** — checkout + subscriptions (EUR, EU VAT, subscription mode). Create the **early-bird Price IDs** (€29 / €59 / €89) so the first-100 lock is a real Stripe pricing setup, not just a promise on a page. Enable **Checkout abandonment recovery**, **Smart Retries**, and dunning.
- ☐ **Scheduler — Metricool (or Later)** — schedule + cross-post IG + YouTube from one place, so Ilan films and the team publishes. One tool, both accounts.
- ☐ **Link-in-bio tool** — Beacons / Stan / Later’s link-in-bio (or a simple hosted page). Structure in D2.
- ☐ **Analytics** — native IG Insights + YouTube Studio for content; **Beehiiv analytics + the Google Sheet lead log** for the numbers that actually matter (leads, pending→confirmed, opens, replies). The scoreboard is leads, not views.

- ☐ **Shared asset drive** — one Google Drive (or equivalent) folder tree, single source for all raw footage, edits, thumbnails, brand kit, and copy. Structure + naming below.
- ☐ **Content tracker / board** — the single source of truth (Section 1.4). Notion or a shared board. Set this up before Week 1.

Shared drive structure + naming convention:

```

ATHLOS-Marketing/
├── 00-brand-kit/           (logo, colors, fonts, templates)
├── 01-raw-footage/         (by content day: 2026-07-14_content-day/)
├── 02-edits/               (finished cuts, ready to schedule)
├── 03-thumbnails/         (YT thumbs + IG covers)
├── 04-copy/                (captions, hooks, email drafts – Slovenian)
├── 05-lead-magnet/         (Tim's 7-day PDFs by sport)
└── 06-published/          (archive of what shipped, for rehashing later)

```

File naming convention (every asset): YYYY-MM-DD_account_pillar_slug_vN.ext

- `account` = `ian` | `athlos`
- `pillar` = `journey` | `znanost` | `trening` | `offer`
- example: `2026-07-15_ian_journey_dan-1-od-30_v2.mp4`
- example: `2026-07-15_ian_znanost_zakaj-split-pocasi_thumb_v3.png`

Consistent naming is what lets the team find, schedule, and later **rehash** any asset without Ian in the loop.

C. THE BRAND KIT (THE HELLENIC LOOK)

The visual differentiation is free — we keep the look, we cut the mythology *content* for the 30-day launch. The look must be consistent across every surface so the machine feels like one brand.

- ☐ **Colors:** Aegean blue (deep) · marble white (bg) · ink (near-black text) · **gold accent** (used sparingly — CTAs, the “” motif, highlights).
- ☐ **Fonts:** **Cinzel / Marcellus** for headlines and the mythic-athlete feel; a clean sans (e.g. Inter) for body and captions so it stays legible on mobile.
- ☐ **Logo usage:** the ATHLOS mark appears on the **@athlos** account, end-cards, and offer graphics. On **Ian's** content it appears small (corner watermark / lower-third), never dominating — Ian's face leads, the logo supports.

- ☐ **Content templates:** build reusable templates for (a) IG cover / hook frame, (b) YouTube thumbnail (Ian's face + big readable Slovenian text + one context visual), (c) the "X/100 mest" counter graphic, (d) the lower-third name strip ("Tim Drenovc · fiziolog"). Store in `00-brand-kit/`.
- ☐ **Tone of visuals:** aspirational, not cheesy — ancient standard, modern (AI) delivery. Marble white, clean, one gold accent. No clutter.

D. COPY & STRUCTURAL ASSETS TO WRITE ONCE

- ☐ **D1 — The offer block** (locked, reuse verbatim everywhere):

PRVIH 100. CENA ZAKLENJENA ZA VEDNO. BASIC — €49 €29/mes · PRO ★
€59/mes · ELITE — €149 €89/mes Ko je 100 mest polnih, cena poskoči. Za vedno.

- ☐ **D2 — Link-in-bio structure** (Ian's account, in order):
 1. 🏛️ **Brezplačen 7-dnevni načrt za tvoj šport** → opt-in page (the primary link, always #1)
 2. **ATHLOS — prvih 100** → offer/waitlist page
 3. **YouTube** → the core VSL
 4. **Tim razloži** → best science piece (once it exists)
- ☐ **D3 — The disqualification line** (raises perceived value, filters DMs):

ATHLOS ni za tiste, ki iščejo bližnjico, trenirajo samo za videz, ali hočejo, da nekdo dela namesto njih.

- ☐ **D4 — Standard soft CTA** (Ian pieces) and **hard CTA** (@athlos pieces):

Soft (Ian): „Delam na tem — brezplačen načrt je v biografiji.” *Hard (ATHLOS):* „Prvih 100 zaklene ceno za vedno. Link v biografiji — ne čakaj, da je polno.”

1.4 The single source of truth — the content board

The whole system runs on **one board**. If it's not on the board, it doesn't exist. This is where an idea becomes a filmed asset becomes a measured result — the machine's dashboard. Build it in Notion (or a shared Trello/Airtable) before Week 1, and give the team edit access so Ian can film while the team moves cards.

THE STAGES (COLUMNS), IDEA → MEASURED



1. **Idea** — a hook + the pillar + the ONE CTA it points to. If it has no CTA path, it's tagged **nurture** on purpose.
2. **Scripted** — the Slovenian hook is written, and the **title + thumbnail concept are decided here** (packaging before filming — principle #7).
3. **Filmed** — raw footage in **01-raw-footage/**, named per convention. This is the only stage that *needs lan*. Batched on one Content Day/week.
4. **Edited** — finished cut in **02-edits/**, caption drafted in Slovenian, thumbnail built. Team-owned, no lan required.
5. **Scheduled** — loaded into Metricool with date/time, cross-post targets ticked (lan IG / @athlos IG / YT Short).
6. **Posted** — live. Link-in-bio and pinned comment both point to the opt-in. Archived to **06-published/**.
7. **Measured** — the only metrics that matter get logged: **leads driven**, saves/shares, watch-through, replies. **Views are noted but never the verdict**. Winners get flagged for future rehashing.

CARD FIELDS (EVERY CONTENT CARD CARRIES THESE)

Field	Values
Pillar	THE JOURNEY · Športna znanost (Tim) · Treniram kot športnik · Offer
Account	lan · @athlos · both
Format	Reel/Short · YouTube long-form · Story · Carousel
Goal	lead (growth, points to offer) · nurture (relationship, core)
CTA / path	e.g. „link v biu → brezplačen načrt”
Packaging	title + thumbnail concept (locked before filming)
Stage	the 7 columns above
Publish date	native Slovenian format, e.g. 15. 7. 2026
Result	leads driven · watch-through · replies (logged at )

The board's non-negotiable rule: every card must have a **Goal** (or) filled in at the Idea stage. That single field enforces principles #2 and #3 — it forces the team to answer *"is this for leads or views?"* before any effort is spent. A card with no Goal doesn't move to Scripted.

Alongside the content board, keep the **lead log** (the Google Sheet: name / sport / source / pending vs confirmed / replied) and a simple **Hot / Warm / Cold** network sheet. Those two, plus the content board, are the three surfaces the whole system runs on.

Blind-spot check — the cold start

Before the team executes any of this, internalize where Iman's model quietly assumes a scale we don't have — and what we do instead. **A setup that ignores the cold start is the wrong setup.**

Iman assumes...	Our reality	So we...
Millions of views feed the top of the funnel	~a dozen warm subs, near-zero cold audience	Treat the warm Beehiiv list as the launch ; reach is the slow second engine, not launch fuel.
Enough audience to run many separate accounts + feeder army	One founder also shipping the app; no clipper budget	Ian's account = ~80% of effort ; @athlos = lean proof repo; cross-post short-form to both from one Content Day.
A back-catalog exists to rehash 14x/week	Empty catalog on day 1	Rehashing is N/A at launch — it becomes the #1 anti-burnout lever <i>after</i> month 1. Note it, don't lean on it yet.
A team of 30 runs the machine	A small team + Ian as the only face	Automate the plumbing, close by hand ; the board lets the team run everything <i>except</i> being on camera.
A high-ticket price means a few thousand qualified views = big money	€29–89/mo B2C — low ticket, needs volume	We <i>do</i> need reach (unlike Iman's business channel), but it must stay on-niche (nogomet/košarka speed) and be judged by leads, not views .
Giant scarcity theater (prize pools, cars) sells	€0 budget, small honest market	Real, modest scarcity only — "prvih 100, za vedno." A fake counter here is permanent trust death.

The one blind spot to keep front of mind: Iman can optimize reach-first because he monetizes later at scale. We have 30 days and a handful of believers who can *actually* seed the first 100. So the machine we build in this manual is warm-list-first, founder-face-led, and manual where it converts. Set the success bar to our scale — **5–20 founding members is a win**, not Iman's screenshots.

Next chapter builds on this: with the accounts, stack, brand kit, and board standing, we move to the content engine — pillars, hooks, packaging, and the Content Day that keeps Iman on camera while the team runs the rest.

2 • What To Film — The Content System

This chapter is the filming manual. Chapter 1 set up why Ian is the face and how the machine turns attention into revenue; this chapter answers the single most common question the team will ask every week: **"OK — so what do we actually point the camera at today?"**

Everything here obeys three rules inherited from the foundation docs and the Iman method:

1. **Ian is IN every piece.** No faceless logo content, no stock B-roll standing in for a founder. People follow a person building something, not a fitness app they've never heard of. If Ian isn't on camera or on the mic, it isn't ATHLOS founder content — it's a product asset (fine, but a different job).
2. **Reverse-engineer from the click.** Before anything gets filmed, we know the path: *this video* → *link in bio* → *free 7-day Tim plan (Beehiiv)* → *early-bird cart*. This is Iman's **Intentional Brand** — content is made backwards from the offer, never forwards from "what would get views."
3. **Cold-start honesty.** We are one founder-ish team also shipping the app, a warm list in the dozens, organic-only, ~30 days. So we shoot for **leads and depth**, not raw reach. Every format below is chosen because one person can actually film it this week with a phone.

2.1 The content pillars and the 3:1 ratio

THE SPINE: THE JOURNEY

Every pillar hangs off one spine — **THE JOURNEY: Ian building ATHLOS in public, training himself on it, racing to put it in the hands of the first 100 athletes.** The "dan X/30" countdown is the narrative thread that makes strangers care about a nobody's fitness app: it turns a product launch into a story with a clock on it. When in doubt what to film, film the journey.

THE THREE PILLARS (FROM 01-BRAND-FOUNDATION.MD §3)

#	Pillar	What it is	What it's FOR	Growth or nurture
1	THE JOURNEY — gradim ATHLOS v živo	Behind-the-scenes of building the app, wins/fails, the “dan X/30” countdown, decisions, the founder’s why.	Parasocial trust + waitlist signups. The spine every week returns to. This is what makes the audience feel like <i>early insiders</i> , which is exactly what converts them into founding-100 buyers.	Nurture (with growth spikes)
2	ŠPORTNA ZNANOST z Timom — česar ti nihče ne pove	Punchy, myth-busting, <i>sport-specific</i> performance science: speed, explosiveness, periodization, why generic splits ruin team-sport athletes. Tim is the credibility anchor.	Reach + proof of the science depth behind the app. Highest viral ceiling — “postal sem hitrejši” science travels. This pillar <i>recruits strangers</i> and <i>earns the right to sell</i> .	Growth
3	TRENIRAM KOT ŠPORTNIK — dokaz na sebi	Ian running ATHLOS’s own generated programming on himself: the process, the numbers, the speed/explosiveness gains, the grind.	Living proof the product works, embodied. Turns “cool app” into “I want that.” Relatability + demonstration in one.	Growth + proof

THE 3:1 GROWTH-TO-NURTURE RATIO (IMAN’S PRINCIPLE, COLD-START-ADJUSTED)

Iman’s rule: **~3 parts growth, ~1 part nurture**. Growth content is broad, curiosity-driven, brings in strangers — “*makes you known*.” Nurture content is lower-reach, higher-trust, deepens the core relationship — “*makes you money*.” The universal mistake is stopping at growth and never converting attention into leads.

For ATHLOS we run roughly 2:1, not 3:1 — and here’s the honest reason (per 01 §3 and the funnel doc). At Iman’s scale, nurture volume is small relative to a giant funnel, so he can afford 3:1. Ian’s warm list is tiny, which makes **each nurture piece disproportionately valuable** — it’s where the launch actually converts. So publicly we lean ~2 growth : 1 nurture, and privately we

treat the **Beehiiv email list as the highest-priority nurture channel of all** (that lives in Chapter on the funnel — email carries the heaviest nurture load, freeing the feed to lean growth).

Practical weekly mix at ~9–12 pieces:

- **~6 growth** (Pillar 2 science + Pillar 3 proof + hot takes) — the reach engine.
- **~3 nurture** (Pillar 1 journey, founder story, day-in-the-life) — the trust/close engine.
- **Every single piece** ends in the same click-path. Growth pieces use a soft CTA (“link v biu, brezplačen načrt”); nurture pieces can go harder (“prvih 100, ne čakaj”).

The tag that goes on everything: before we film, we write two words on the shot list — the **pillar** (1/2/3) and the **job** (growth/nurture). If we can’t name the job, we don’t shoot it. That discipline *is* the Intentional Brand.

2.2 The video-type catalog — the menu Iman films from

This is the concrete format library. When the team plans a Content Day (see §2.4), they pick formats off this menu — not “let’s make a video,” but “let’s make a **myth-bust** and a **founder-trains-on-it proof** and two **listicles**.” Each format below gives: what it is, why it works (the Iman framework it leans on), which pillar/job, ideal length, platform, and two ready SL hooks.

All hooks are in the first 2 seconds. Iman: **packaging is 80%** — the hook and the framing decide whether anyone watches. The hooks below are written to be said/shown in the first frame.

FORMAT 1 — BUILD-IN-PUBLIC “DAN X/30”

- **What it is:** Raw phone update on where the build is today. One win, one struggle, one decision. Shot in ~60 seconds, no production.
- **Why it works:** Iman’s **documentation-before-education** + the **Intentional Brand** — a countdown creates narrative tension and a reason to come back tomorrow. Strangers who watch “dan 6” feel obligated to see “dan 7.”
- **Pillar / job:** Pillar 1 · **nurture** (the spine).
- **Length / platform:** 30–60s · IG Reels + YT Shorts (cross-post), Stories.
- **SL hooks:**
 - *“Dan 9 od 30. Danes se mi je sesula cela baza vaj — pa sem vseeno bližje kot včeraj.”*
 - *“30 dni, da spravim ATHLOS v roke prvih 100 športnikov. Poglej, kje sem danes.”*

FORMAT 2 — MYTH-BUST

- **What it is:** Name a belief every Slovenian gym kid holds, then demolish it with Tim's science. One myth per video.
- **Why it works: Problem Farming** (turns audience pain into an endless backlog) + a **clear enemy** (generic bodybuilding splits). Contrarian hooks earn watch-time; being *against* something is more shareable than being *for* something.
- **Pillar / job:** Pillar 2 · **growth** (highest viral ceiling).
- **Length / platform:** 30–60s short + can expand to a 6–10 min YT long-form · IG + YT.
- **SL hooks:**
 - *"Zakaj te 'klasičen split' z Instagrama dela POČASNEJŠEGA (in kaj delati namesto tega)."*
 - *"Nogometaš, ki dela bench press ponedeljek–petek, dela največjo napako v karieri. Evo zakaj."*

FORMAT 3 — TIM SCIENCE CUT-IN

- **What it is:** Tim on camera for 20–40 seconds explaining ONE protocol or mechanism ("zakaj plyometrija", "kako periodizirati okoli tekem"). Ian frames it; Tim delivers it.
- **Why it works: Effortless front, best-in-class backend** — Tim's scarcity *is* his authority. He doesn't run an account or post daily; his rare appearances transfer credibility to Ian and the app. Trust flows Tim → app.
- **Pillar / job:** Pillar 2 · **growth + proof**.
- **Length / platform:** 20–45s short (or a segment inside a long-form) · IG + YT.
- **SL hooks:**
 - *"Vprašal sem fiziologa Tima: zakaj večina športnikov nikoli ne postane hitrejših. Odgovor te bo presenetil."*
 - *"Tim razloži v 40 sekundah, kako pravilno narediti prvi korak eksploziven."*

FORMAT 4 — FOUNDER-TRAINS-ON-IT PROOF

- **What it is:** Ian doing the actual ATHLOS-generated workout — sprint work, plyos, the session the app told him to do today — with the screen shown.
- **Why it works: Documentation** + embodied proof. The founder eating his own cooking is the least fakeable content there is. It answers "does this thing even work?" without a single claim.
- **Pillar / job:** Pillar 3 · **growth + proof**.
- **Length / platform:** 30–60s short · IG + YT; also feeds long-form "teden X rezultati".

- **SL hooks:**
 - *"Aplikacija mi je danes napisala trening. Poglej, kako je videti, ko ga dejansko narediš."*
 - *"30 dni treniram samo po tem, kar generira moja lastna app. Teden 1: to se je zgodilo."*

FORMAT 5 — ATHLETE TRANSFORMATION / RESULTS

- **What it is:** A real athlete's before/after — sprint time, vertical jump, a number that moved. Early on this is Ian himself; post-launch it's founding members and beta testers.
- **Why it works: Optimize for leads not views** — a visible, emotional, *measurable* outcome ("–0,2s na 20m") is the single most persuasive asset for a performance product. Speed is shareable in a way hypertrophy never is.
- **Pillar / job:** Pillar 3 · **growth + proof** (converts hard).
- **Length / platform:** 30–60s short · IG + YT; testimonial version → sales page.
- **SL hooks:**
 - *"Pred 6 tedni je tekel 20m v 3,1s. Danes 2,9s. Nič čarobnega — samo pravi sistem."*
 - *"Ta košarkar je dvignil vertikal za 7cm v enem mesecu. Točno to je delal."*

FORMAT 6 — "HOW TO" TUTORIAL

- **What it is:** One concrete, do-it-today technique — a drill, a warm-up, a cue. Pure value, screen-recordable or demonstrated.
- **Why it works: Minefield/search farming** — high-intent, durable content that compounds and ranks. Someone searching "kako hitreje sprintati" is a *qualified* lead, not a random scroller.
- **Pillar / job:** Pillar 2 · **growth** (search-durable).
- **Length / platform:** 45–90s short + strong YT long-form candidate · IG + YT.
- **SL hooks:**
 - *"3 koraki do bolj eksplozivnega štarta — naredi jih pred vsakim treningom."*
 - *"Kako pravilno narediti drop jump (99% ga dela narobe)."*

FORMAT 7 — DAY-IN-THE-LIFE

- **What it is:** A day of the founder-athlete: training, building the app, meeting Tim, the grind behind the launch.
- **Why it works:** Iman's classic **nurture** format ("a day in the life" = "makes you money"). Lower reach, high engagement, deep parasocial bond. This is the piece that converts a follower into a *fan*.
- **Pillar / job:** Pillar 1 · **nurture**.
- **Length / platform:** 60–90s short or 5–8 min YT vlog · IG + YT.

- **SL hooks:**

- *"En dan v življenju, ko gradiš športno app in jo treniraš na sebi hkrati."*
- *"5:40 zjutraj. 12 dni do lansiranja. Poglej, kako izgleda moj dan."*

FORMAT 8 — HOT TAKE / OPINION

- **What it is:** A strong, defensible opinion about Slovenian sport/fitness culture, said straight to camera. Take a side.
- **Why it works:** **Content trifecta** applied to *what you say* — opinion content is inherently high-watch-time because viewers stay to agree or argue. Establishes Ian's **FOR/AGAINST** positioning (against generic aesthetics culture).
- **Pillar / job:** Pillar 2 (culture) · **growth**.
- **Length / platform:** 30–50s short · IG + YT.
- **SL hooks:**
 - *"Nepopularno mnenje: 90% slovenskih mladih športnikov trenira, kot da hoče biti body-builder — in zato so počasni."*
 - *"Osebni trenerji v Sloveniji so predragi za to, kar dobiš. Zato gradim to."*

FORMAT 9 — BEHIND-THE-APP DEMO

- **What it is:** Screen recording of ATHLOS doing its thing — the Coach generating a plan, the daily report, the season calendar, biometrija.
- **Why it works:** **Documentation** + proof-of-substance ("AI, ki dejansko ve nekaj o tvojem športu", the counter to AI-hype). Shows the product is real before anyone's asked to pay.
- **Pillar / job:** Pillar 1/product · **nurture + proof**.
- **Length / platform:** 30–60s short · IG + YT; also → the VSL and sales page.
- **SL hooks:**
 - *"Vpišem 'nogomet, 17 let, hitrost' — in v 5 sekundah dobim tole. Poglej."*
 - *"To ni še en fitnes tracker. Poglej, kako ATHLOS napiše cel sezonski načrt."*

FORMAT 10 — STORY / ORIGIN

- **What it is:** The founder's why. Why Ian is building this, the problem that made him start, the moment it clicked.
- **Why it works:** **Documentation-before-education** + the deepest **nurture** move. Origin stories are the trust-close for fence-sitters — this is the "makes you money" content in its purest form.
- **Pillar / job:** Pillar 1 · **nurture** (highest-trust).
- **Length / platform:** 60–90s short or a segment of the VSL · IG + YT.

- **SL hooks:**
 - *"Nikoli nisem imel strokovne ekipe za sabo. Zato gradim tako, da jo bo imel vsak."*
 - *"Zakaj sem pustil vse ostalo, da zgradim ATHLOS. Iskreno."*

FORMAT 11 — LISTICLE ("3 VAJE ZA ...")

- **What it is:** A fast numbered list — 3 exercises, 3 mistakes, 3 drills. Snackable, saveable, shareable.
- **Why it works: Packaging is 80%** — a number in the hook ("3 vaje") is a proven CTR pattern; listicles get saved and re-watched, which the algorithm rewards. Cheap to batch-film.
- **Pillar / job:** Pillar 2 · **growth**.
- **Length / platform:** 30–45s short · IG + YT.
- **SL hooks:**
 - *"3 vaje za hitrejši prvi korak, ki jih ne dela skoraj nihče."*
 - *"3 napake, zaradi katerih nogometaši ostanejo počasni (delaš vsaj eno)."*

FORMAT 12 — REACTION / DUET

- **What it is:** Ian reacts to a viral Slovenian/Balkan fitness clip or a bad piece of training advice, correcting or building on it.
- **Why it works: Study other niches, not competitors** + borrowed reach — reacting to existing content piggybacks on its momentum and positions Ian as the knowledgeable authority. Low effort, high relevance.
- **Pillar / job:** Pillar 2 · **growth**.
- **Length / platform:** 30–60s short · IG + TikTok (duet-native) + YT.
- **SL hooks:**
 - *"Ta 'nasvet za hitrost' ima 200k ogledov in je popolnoma narobe. Popravimo ga."*
 - *"Reagiram na najbolj precejeno vajo na slovenskem fitnes Instagramu."*

FORMAT 13 — TESTIMONIAL

- **What it is:** A member/beta tester/coach saying, in their words, what changed. First-person, unscripted.
- **Why it works: No-leak backend** proof asset + social proof — the highest-converting content type for a paid product. Doubles as a sales-page and launch-email asset.
- **Pillar / job:** Pillar 3 · **proof / conversion**.
- **Length / platform:** 20–45s short · IG + YT; sales page + launch emails.

- **SL hooks:**

- *"Prvič v življenju vem, da treniram pravilno." — Luka, 19, nogomet."*
- *"Vprašal sem prvega beta uporabnika, kaj bi rekel nekemu, ki okleva. Tole je rekel."*

FORMAT 14 — POV / RELATABLE

- **What it is:** A "POV:"-framed relatable moment every serious young athlete lives — the loneliness of taking training more seriously than your teammates, the confusion of not knowing if you're doing it right.
- **Why it works: Problem Farming** in its most emotional form — relatability content spreads because viewers tag each other ("to si ti"). It surfaces the exact pains the ICP feels (from 01 §2), which primes them for the solution.
- **Pillar / job:** Pillar 1/2 · **growth** (recruits the exact ICP).
- **Length / platform:** 15–40s short · IG + TikTok + YT.
- **SL hooks:**
 - *"POV: edini v ekipi si, ki trening jemlje resno — in nihče ti ne zna povedati, ali delaš prav."*
 - *"POV: plačaš €40 za osebne trenerja in ti da isti generični plan kot vsem ostalim."*

How to read this menu: Formats 2, 6, 8, 11, 12 are your **growth workhorses** (film many, cheap). Formats 1, 7, 10 are your **nurture spine** (fewer, deeper). Formats 4, 5, 9, 13 are your **proof engine** (they convert — over-index on these as the launch nears). Format 3 (Tim) is your **credibility injector** — sprinkle it across all three jobs.

2.3 The core converting video — the Flywheel VSL

This is the **one long-form video** that argues a Slovenian athlete into wanting ATHLOS. Iman's **Flywheel VSL** principle: record ONE evergreen video, once; every other piece links back to it; it compounds into a 24/7 salesman.

IMAN'S PREREQUISITE — AND IAN'S SHORTCUT

Iman says you **cannot** record the VSL cold: you build ~15–30 videos on the micro-channel first *to discover the right topic and angle*. **Ian's cold-start shortcut** (per 04 §5.1 and the 01 blind-spot table): the topic is already known — **it's the launch pitch itself**. We don't need 30 videos to find it. So we build it in Week 2–3, after ~10–15 short pieces have taught us which hooks land, and we fold those winning hooks straight into the VSL. We do **not** burn Week 1 on a VSL no one will see yet.

Right-sized: **aim 8–15 minutes**, not Iman's 38 — cold Slovenian channel, MVP offer, a founder-to-camera piece shot honestly, re-cut after launch.

THE TITLE (SL)

”Zakaj generični treningi delajo slovenske športnike počasnejše — in kako to popravim (v živo, na sebi).”

Alt / thumbnail-line variant: *”Zgradil sem strokovno ekipo, ki jo imajo samo veliki klubi — za ceno dveh treningov na mesec.”*

BEAT-BY-BEAT OUTLINE

1. **Hook (0:00–0:15) — the enemy, named.** *”Če treniraš nogomet ali košarko in slediš ‘split-om’ z Instagrama, te ta video reši ene največjih napak v karieri.”* Promise + stakes in the first frame. (Packaging = 80%.)
2. **The problem (0:15–2:00) — Problem Farming.** The five ICP pains in their own words (01 §2): “ne vem, ali treniram prav”, generic English PDFs, no periodization around the season, nobody programs for *your* sport, injuries from unmanaged load. Make the viewer feel *seen*. No pitch yet.
3. **Why it's not your fault (2:00–3:30).** The real cause: elite athletes have a *strokovna ekipa* — physiolog + trener + sezonski planer — that costs €200–500+/month in Slovenia. You've been fighting alone against people who have a team. Reframe: the problem is access, not effort.
4. **The idea (3:30–5:00) — the big reframe.** *”Kaj če bi vsak športnik imel to ekipo — kot AI sistem, ki pozna njegov šport, v slovenščini, za ceno dveh treningov?”* Introduce ATHLOS as the concept, Tim as the science behind it.
5. **Proof it's real (5:00–8:00) — Documentation + demo.** Screen-share the Coach generating a real sport-specific plan live. Cut to Ian doing the session. Cut to a Tim science soundbite. Cut to a number that moved. This is the “it works” block — show, don't claim.
6. **Who it's NOT for (8:00–9:00) — Disqualification.** State plainly: not for shortcut-seekers, aesthetics-only trainers, or people who want someone to train *for* them. This raises perceived value and makes the right-fit viewer feel chosen (01 §4).
7. **The offer + why now (9:00–11:00) — Anchoring + honest scarcity.** The €200–500 human-team anchor first, *then* the price: BASIC €49 €29 / PRO ★ €99 €59 / ELITE €149 €89. The **first 100 lock the price for life**. Three converging “why now”s: AI is finally good enough, nobody's done this for Slovenian athletes, the door closes at 100.
8. **One CTA (11:00–end) — No-leak.** A single instruction: *”Povezava spodaj. Vpiši se na listo, dobiš brezplačen 7-dnevni Timov načrt — in prvo mesto med prvih 100.”* One click-path, nothing else.

HOW EVERY OTHER VIDEO LINKS BACK TO IT

The VSL is the **gravitational center**. Iman’s flywheel: every new piece feeds the VSL, the rising traffic gets the algorithm to amplify it, and it compounds (“the older it gets, the more it sells”).

Concretely for ATHLOS:

- **Shorts** end with “cela zgodba v enem videu — link v biu / v opisu.” The short is the hook; the VSL is the argument.
- **Email N4** (“poglej, kaj sem zgradil”) links the VSL for the first time; **L1** (cart open) links it again.
- **Every bio and pinned comment** points to the VSL or the opt-in that follows it.
- **Post-launch**, when the channel has traffic, we run Iman’s **content-rehashing** on it (new thumbnail + title only) to keep it climbing — but that’s a month-2 lever (empty catalog now).

Blind-spot honesty (04 §5.1): at launch the VSL’s job is **not** to be found by strangers — it won’t get millions of cold views. Its job is to be the trust-and-convert asset Ian links in *every email, every bio, every DM*. It converts the traffic Ian already routes to it. It becomes Iman’s evergreen gravity center *later*, as the channel grows.

2.4 Short-form vs long-form — and the remix

WHAT BELONGS WHERE

	Short-form (Reels / Shorts)	Long-form (YouTube)
Job	Reach + top-of-funnel + daily presence. The hook that pulls a stranger in.	Depth + trust + the <i>convert</i> . The argument that closes.
Formats	1, 2, 4, 5, 6, 8, 11, 12, 13, 14 — most of the menu.	The VSL (§2.3); occasional myth-bust or tutorial expanded to 6–10 min; day-in-the-life vlog.
Cadence	Daily-ish (~1/day, batch-filmed).	~1 real video (the VSL) for launch; more post-launch.
Platform	IG Reels + YT Shorts (cross-post), TikTok optional.	YouTube, under Ian’s channel (the buyer must trust the founder-athlete first).
Cold-start note	The reach engine, but a <i>slow trickle</i> from a cold start — seeds month 2+, doesn’t carry launch.	One is enough for launch. Don’t run a weekly YT machine yet.

Placement rule: the founder-athlete's *face and daily presence* live in short-form; the *full argument* lives in the one long-form. Product-only assets (pure demos, testimonials) can also live on the @athlos repository account, but the person is always on the personal channel.

HOW ONE LONG-FORM BECOMES ~8–10 SHORTS

Iman's **content-rehashing / repurposing** logic, right-sized. The VSL is shot as one continuous piece but *planned* so each beat is independently clippable. From the 8-beat VSL you extract:

1. The enemy hook (beat 1) → a myth-bust short.
2. Each of 2–3 ICP pains (beat 2) → 2–3 POV/relatable shorts.
3. The €200–500 “strokovna ekipa” reframe (beat 3) → one hot-take short.
4. The live Coach demo (beat 5) → a behind-the-app short.
5. Iman doing the session (beat 5) → a founder-proof short.
6. The Tim soundbite (beat 5) → a Tim science cut-in.
7. The disqualification block (beat 6) → a “ATHLOS ni za ...” short.
8. The offer/why-now (beat 7) → a launch/scarcity short (held for launch week).

That's **~9 shorts from one shoot** — one Content Day yields a week-plus of feed.

Cold-start reality (from 00–START–HERE §”Cut or defer”): do **not** treat the 8–10-shorts math as a mandate this month — “nobody’s watching enough yet.” **Post the clips that are genuinely good, ignore the ones that aren’t.** The remix engine is real but its full value arrives in month 2+ when there’s an audience to catch the volume. For launch: one Content Day/week, cut 3 good shorts *if* it makes anything, and let the VSL do the heavy converting.

THE CONTENT DAY (IMAN’S BATCH PRINCIPLE)

Batch-film one day a week (Iman: “Content Day” — 2–5 pieces in one sitting). Good audio + a clean background beats fancy gear. One session: shoot the day’s journey update, 2–3 myth-busts/tutorials, one Tim cut-in if Tim’s there, one founder-training clip. Everything else that week is raw phone documentation (Format 1), which needs no setup.

2.5 The starter content bank — the first 20 videos

Ready to shoot **this week**. Each row: SL hook/title, format (from §2.2), pillar, and growth/nurture tag. Ordered so the team can film top-to-bottom — the first Content Day covers roughly rows 1–8.

#	SL hook / title	Format	Pillar	G/N
1	"Dan 1 od 30. Gradim ATHLOS — športno app, ki jo treniram na sebi. Poglej od začetka."	1 · dan X/30	1	N
2	"Zakaj te 'klasičen split' z Instagrama dela POČASNEJŠEGA (in kaj namesto tega)."	2 · myth-bust	2	G
3	"3 vaje za hitrejši prvi korak, ki jih ne dela skoraj nihče."	11 · listicle	2	G
4	"Aplikacija mi je danes napisala trening. Poglej, kako izgleda, ko ga narediš."	4 · founder-proof	3	G
5	"Nikoli nisem imel strokovne ekipe za sabo. Zato gradim tako, da jo bo imel vsak."	10 · origin	1	N
6	"Vprašal sem fiziologa Tima: zakaj večina športnikov nikoli ne postane hitrejših."	3 · Tim cut-in	2	G
7	"POV: edini v ekipi si, ki trening jemlje resno — in nihče ti ne zna povedati, ali delaš prav."	14 · POV	1/2	G
8	"Nepopularno mnenje: mladi slovenski športniki trenirajo kot bodybuilderji — in zato so počasni."	8 · hot take	2	G
9	"Vpišem 'nogomet, 17 let, hitrost' — in v 5 sekundah dobim tole. Poglej ATHLOS."	9 · app demo	1	N
10	"Kako pravilno narediti drop jump (99% ga dela narobe)."	6 · tutorial	2	G
11	"Dan 5 od 30. Danes se mi je sesula baza vaj — pa sem vseeno bližje."	1 · dan X/30	1	N
12	"3 napake, zaradi katerih nogometaši ostanejo počasni (delaš vsaj eno)."	11 · listicle	2	G
13	"Ta 'nasvet za hitrost' ima 200k ogledov in je popolnoma narobe. Popravimo ga."	12 · reaction	2	G
14	"En dan v življenju, ko gradiš športno app in jo treniraš na sebi hkrati."	7 · day-in-life	1	N
15	"Tim razloži v 40 sekundah, kako periodizirati trening okoli tekem."	3 · Tim cut-in	2	G
16	"30 dni treniram samo po tem, kar generira moja app. Teden 1: to se je zgodilo."	5 · transforma-	3	G

#	SL hook / title	Format	Pillar	G/N
		tion		
17	"POV: plačáš €40 za osebnega trenerja in dobiš isti generični plan kot vsi."	14 · POV	2	G
18	"To ni še en fitnes tracker. Poglej, kako ATHLOS napiše cel sezonski načrt."	9 · app demo	1	N
19	"Košarkar, ki dviguje težo za videz namesto za eksplozivnost, dela napako. Evo zakaj."	2 · myth-bust	2	G
20	"Dan 12 od 30. Skoraj tu. Prvih 100 zaklene ceno za vedno — povem ti, kaj to pomeni."	1 · dan X/30	1	N

Bank composition check: 13 growth / 7 nurture $\approx$ **~2:1** — exactly the cold-start ratio from §2.1. Every nurture piece is the journey spine or the app itself (the trust engine); every growth piece is science, proof, or a relatable pain that recruits the exact ICP. Rows 9, 16, 18 double as proof assets for the VSL and launch emails.

Blind-spot check

Where this chapter leans on Iman and where the cold start forces a change — so the team never over-applies a framework built for scale:

- **3:1 $\rightarrow$ 2:1 ratio.** Iman's 3:1 assumes a big funnel where nurture is a small slice. Ian's warm list is tiny, so nurture is disproportionately valuable — we run ~2:1 in the feed and let **email carry the heaviest nurture load**. Don't starve the trust engine chasing reach.
- **The remix engine is deferred, not deleted.** "One long-form $\rightarrow$ 8–10 shorts" is a real system, but at cold start nobody's watching enough to justify the volume. Post the *good* clips, ignore the math this month (`00-START-HERE`). It becomes a core lever in month 2+.
- **The VSL doesn't get found — it gets sent.** Iman's VSL works on millions of feeder views. Ian's won't get cold reach at launch. Its job is to convert the traffic Ian *already routes to it* via emails, bios, and DMs. Build it once, let it compound later.
- **Content-rehashing is N/A now.** No back-catalog exists to repackage. Note it as Ian's #1 anti-burnout lever *after* month 1 — don't try to use it in Week 1.
- **The topic-discovery prerequisite is shortcut, not skipped.** Iman needs 15–30 videos to find the VSL angle; Ian's angle is the launch pitch itself, so ~10–15 shorts to *validate hooks* is enough. But we still validate before we film the VSL — we don't shoot it blind on Day 1.

- **Every format assumes one person with a phone.** No format in the catalog requires a crew, a studio, or a paid clipper army (Iman's Content Rewards is off the table, €0 budget). If a format can't be shot by Ian + Tim on a Content Day, it's not in the bank.
- **Reach stays on-niche.** Unlike Iman's business channel (deliberately small, high-ticket), ATHLOS is low-ticket B2C and *does* need volume — but volume of the *right* people. A viral generic-motivation clip that pulls in non-athletes is a failure, not a win. Judge every piece by **waitlist signups**, not view count (04 \$7).

Chapter 2 gives the team the full filming menu, the one converting video, and 20 shots ready to roll. Ian is on camera in every growth and nurture piece; Tim injects credibility on a light schedule; and every asset is reverse-engineered from the same click-path to the free Tim plan and the first-100 cart.

3 · How To Film — The Production Playbook

This is the most hands-on chapter in the manual, and the most important one for the founder-as-face model. Everything upstream — positioning, the funnel, the offer — is worthless if we can't reliably put Ian on camera and produce content the team can turn into leads.

Read this as a build spec. By the end you should be able to walk into a session, shoot 5–10 pieces, and hand a clean folder of footage to editing without anyone improvising.

The one rule that governs this whole chapter: *Ian is the only one who can be on camera. Everyone else builds the machine around him.* We design every part of production so that Ian's job is small, repeatable, and low-friction — show up, be a person, talk — and the team absorbs all the complexity (kit, setup, shot lists, files, editing, packaging). If a decision makes Ian's on-camera job harder, it's the wrong decision. See §3.7.

Iman lens: Iman spends only 3–5 hours/month actually creating; his team does the rest (“effortless front, best-in-class backend”). We can't match that team yet — but we build toward it from day one by making Ian's part tiny and the pipeline around him as systematized as our size allows.

Cold-start reality: we are one founder also shipping the app, a tiny warm list, organic, ~30 days. We do NOT have a studio, a videographer, or a clipper army. This chapter is deliberately phone-first and batching-first, because a solo founder's scarcest resource is on-camera time.

Batching is the answer to that scarcity — it is the load-bearing idea of this chapter (§3.5).

3.1 · The Kit — Phone-First Gear List

We shoot on a phone. Not “for now until we can afford a camera” — on purpose. A modern phone shoots better video than most people's cameras, it's always in Ian's pocket, and it removes every excuse to not film. Iman's own rule: *good audio + a clean background beats fancy gear*. Fancy gear is a way to procrastinate. We reject it.

The single biggest quality upgrade is not the camera — it's the **microphone**. Viewers forgive mediocre video; they will not forgive bad audio. They click away in the first two seconds if it sounds echoey or hollow. So the mic is the one place we spend money first (§3.2 explains why).

THE LIST (CHEAP VS BETTER)

Item	Cheap / start-today	Better (when there's budget)	Why it matters
Camera	The phone Ian already owns (iPhone with 4K is ideal; any recent phone is fine)	Same phone — don't upgrade the camera before the mic	It's already good enough. Reject the camera-upgrade excuse.
Microphone	Wired lavalier (clip-on) into the phone (~€20–30), OR the phone's own mic in a small quiet room as a last resort	Wireless lav kit (DJI Mic Mini / Rode Wireless-type, ~€100–150) — clips on, no cable, moves with Ian	The #1 upgrade. Audio > video, always. A €25 lav beats a €1,000 camera with the built-in mic.
Tripod / stability	Cheap phone tripod + phone clamp (~€15), or lean the phone against books	Small tripod with a phone mount + a gimbal (DJI Osmo-type, ~€100) for walking/movement B-roll	Static talking-head = tripod. Movement/B-roll = gimbal. Shaky footage reads as amateur.
Lighting	A window (free — see §3.2). North-facing, soft daylight.	One softbox or a large ring/soft LED panel (~€40–80) for consistent indoor light regardless of weather	Consistent light = a recognizable, professional look across the batch. Window light is genuinely great — but it changes with the weather, which breaks batching consistency.
Storage / files	Phone's own storage, cleared before a session; back up to cloud (Google Drive / iCloud) after	A fast USB-C SSD or a paid cloud tier for 4K footage	4K footage is huge. Running out of space mid-session kills a Content Day. Always start a session with space cleared.

"YOU CAN START TODAY WITH JUST X"

You can start today with: your phone, a €25 clip-on lav mic, a €15 tripod, and a window. That's the entire minimum viable kit. Total under €50. Everything else on the list is an optimization we add later, not a prerequisite. If Ian is waiting on gear to start, he's procrastinating — the excuse is already dead.

3.2 · The Setup — How To Physically Shoot

This is the checklist the team sets up *before* Ian sits down. Ian should walk into a room where framing, background, light, and audio are already handled. His job is to talk; the setup is ours.

FRAMING

- **Headroom:** leave a small, consistent gap above Ian's head — not too much (floating in space), not cropping the top of his head. A thumb's width at the top of frame.
- **Rule of thirds:** Ian's eyes sit on the **upper third** line, not dead-center. Turn on the phone's grid (Settings → Camera → Grid on iPhone) and place the eyes on that top horizontal line every time. This is the single fastest way to make a shot look intentional instead of like a webcam.
- **Eye-line:** Ian looks slightly into the lens, not down at it. The phone should be at roughly **eye height or a touch above** — never below (shooting up the nose is unflattering and reads amateur). Prop the tripod up to eye level.
- **Distance:** medium-close. Chest-up for talking-head. Close enough to feel personal and intimate, not a security-camera wide shot. For vertical (Reels/Shorts), frame a little tighter — head and shoulders — because phones are held close.

BACKGROUND — WHAT READS WELL

We have three environments, each with a job:

- **Gym / training floor** (*the hero environment*). This is where ATHLOS content should live most of the time — it's on-brand, it's proof, it signals "athlete, not influencer at a desk." Racks, turf, a court in the background. Depth behind Ian (don't back him flat against a wall — a few meters of gym behind him gives professional depth-of-field). This is the default for pillars 2 (science with Tim) and 3 (Ian training).
- **Home / clean indoor** (*THE JOURNEY / build-in-public*). A tidy, simple background — a plain wall with one or two intentional objects (a plant, a ball, nothing cluttered). This is where the founder-story, "dan X/30," and build-in-public talking-heads live. Clean beats fancy. Kill visual clutter — a messy background is the fastest way to look unprofessional.
- **Outdoors** (*reach / atmosphere*). A track, a pitch, a court, a stadium exterior. Great for hooks and B-roll, high energy, but **only shoot outdoors when the weather cooperates** — wind ruins audio (a lav windscreen/foam cover helps) and changing light breaks consistency. Treat outdoors as a bonus environment, not the reliable one.

Rule: pick a background that says "athlete" and has depth, and keep it consistent within a batch so the pieces feel like a series.

LIGHTING

- **Natural window light is the free hero.** Ian faces the window (light on his face), never with the window behind him (that silhouettes him — the phone exposes for the bright window and Ian goes dark). Soft, indirect daylight from a north-facing window is flattering and free.
- **Ring light or soft LED panel** for consistency when daylight isn't available or when batching across hours (the sun moves; a lamp doesn't). Position it in front of Ian, slightly above eye level, angled down — mimicking natural overhead light.
- **Avoid:** harsh overhead ceiling lights alone (they cast raccoon shadows under the eyes); mixed color temperatures (a warm lamp + cool daylight makes skin look sickly — pick one); backlighting that silhouettes; and any flickering light (cheap LEDs can strobe on camera).

AUDIO — WHY AUDIO BEATS VIDEO

If we get one thing right, it's this. **Bad audio makes people leave in the first two seconds; mediocre video does not.** The brain tolerates a soft image; it will not tolerate echo, hiss, or hollow room sound. Concretely:

- **Use the lav mic, always.** Clip it on Ian's shirt, roughly a hand's width below the chin, centered. Hide the cable if wired. Test-record 5 seconds and play it back before the real take — every session.
- **Shoot in a quiet, soft room.** Hard empty rooms echo. Rooms with soft furnishings (couch, curtains, rugs, clothes) sound better. Turn off fans, AC, the fridge hum, notifications. A gym can be echoey and loud — for talking-head *in* a gym, still rely on the lav close to the mouth, and shoot when the gym is quiet.
- **Never rely on the phone's built-in mic for talking-head** unless you're in a genuinely small, soft, silent room and have no lav. The lav is the whole difference between "amateur" and "clean."

PHONE SETTINGS (SET THESE ONCE, LOCK THEM PER SESSION)

- **Resolution / fps:** 4K at 30fps for the standard look. 4K gives editing room to crop and re-frame (important for cutting one horizontal long-form into vertical shorts — §3.6). Use 60fps only when you specifically want slow-motion B-roll (training clips).
- **Lock exposure and focus:** on iPhone, tap-and-hold on Ian's face until "AE/AF LOCK" appears. This stops the shot from hunting — auto-exposure drifting brighter/darker mid-sentence, or focus breathing in and out, both scream amateur. Lock it on the face before every take.

- **Orientation — per platform:**

- **Vertical (9:16)** for Reels, Shorts, TikTok — this is where most of our reach lives, so it's the default for short-form.
 - **Horizontal (16:9)** for the YouTube long-form / VSL — the core converting video (per `04-funnel-sales-system.md §5.1`) is shot horizontal.
 - **The pro move:** shoot the long-form horizontal in 4K, framed with enough room around Ian that editing can *crop it to vertical* for shorts. One shoot, both formats (§3.6).
-

3.3 · On-Camera Delivery — How Ian Should Present

This is the part only Ian can do, so it deserves the most care. The goal is not “be a polished presenter.” The goal is **be a real, high-conviction person the viewer trusts**. In a small Slovenian market where authenticity is the whole moat (per `01-brand-foundation.md §3` — Ian is the founder-athlete, the person IS the moat), polish that reads as “influencer” actually *hurts* us. We want one-of-one, not one-of-many.

Iman lens: packaging and the first seconds are 80% of the game; and the founder's job is to be *known and trusted*, not slick. Ian doesn't need to perform — he needs to be *the guy building this, on camera*.

ENERGY

- Bring energy **one notch above** how you feel in a normal conversation. The camera flattens energy — what feels like “a bit much” in the room reads as “normal and engaged” on screen. Flat, low-energy delivery is the #1 reason good content dies.
- Not fake-hyped, not a caffeine ad — just *lean in, mean it*. Ian genuinely cares about this (he's building it and training on it); let that conviction show.

THE FIRST-3-SECONDS HOOK RULE

The first three seconds decide whether anyone watches the rest. No slow intros, no “hey guys, welcome back,” no logo animation. Open on the most interesting sentence. State the hook, on camera, immediately — or lead with a visual that stops the scroll.

Slovenian hook patterns Ian can open cold with (idiomatic, spoken, not written):

- “*Če treniraš nogomet in delaš klasičen ‘split’ iz Instagrama — delaš se počasnejšega. Razložim.*”
- “*Nihče v Sloveniji ti ne pove tega o hitrosti. Zato sem zgradil aplikacijo, ki ti.*”
- “*Dan 12 od 30. Danes se je skoraj vse sesulo.*”

- *"To je največja napaka, ki jo dela vsak mlad košarkaš pri treningu eksplozivnosti."*
- *"Osebni trener + kineziolog + fizioterapevt = 400 evrov na mesec. Ali pa to."*
- *"Ne verjameš, da lahko AI naredi pravi trening za tvoj šport? Poglej."*

The pattern: name the enemy, or promise a specific payoff, or open mid-story — in the first sentence, before anything else.

PACING

- Talk a little faster than feels natural and **cut every dead moment in editing** (§3.6). Short-form has no room for "umm," pauses, or throat-clearing.
- One idea per breath. Deliver a point, breathe, next point. This gives editing clean cut points.
- Vary the rhythm — a fast run of sentences, then one slow, weighted line for emphasis. Monotone pacing loses people even if the content is good.

EYE CONTACT WITH THE LENS

- Look at **the lens itself**, not at your own face on the screen. Put a tiny sticker or arrow next to the lens as a reminder. Looking at the screen means looking slightly off — the viewer feels talked-past instead of talked-to.
- Direct lens eye contact is what creates the parasocial "he's talking to me" feeling that builds trust and, downstream, leads.

TALK LIKE A PERSON, NOT A PRESENTER

- Speak the way Ian would explain this to a training partner in the gym, not the way he'd narrate a corporate video. Contractions, real Slovenian, the odd bit of slang the athlete audience uses.
- **Read vs speak:** do NOT read a script word-for-word off the screen — it always looks read (the eyes track, the delivery flattens). Instead: know the 3 beats you want to hit (hook → point → CTA), then *talk* through them naturally. Bullet points on a note, not a paragraph to recite. The one exception is the tightly-scripted hook line — that's worth nailing verbatim.
- If a take comes out stiff, say the line out loud once as if venting to a friend, then roll — the second, looser version is almost always the keeper.

HANDS AND GESTURES

- Use hands naturally — gesturing on camera reads as confidence and energy, and it's how Ian talks anyway. Frozen, hands-at-sides delivery looks nervous.
- Keep gestures within the frame (don't wave out of shot). For chest-up framing, gestures near the chest/face read best.

RETAKES

- **Retakes are free and expected.** Fluff a line? Don't stop, don't sigh, don't restart the whole thing — pause for one beat and say the line again. Editing keeps the good take and cuts the flub. This keeps energy up and avoids the death spiral of “let me start over” (attempt 8 is always worse than attempt 2).
- Cap it: if a piece won't come out right after ~3 tries, move on and come back. Grinding one clip kills the whole Content Day's momentum.

DO / DON'T

DO:

- Bring energy one notch up.
- Hook in the first 3 seconds.
- Look at the lens.
- Talk like you're in the gym, not on stage.
- Use your hands.
- Retake the line, not the whole clip.
- Be specific and opinionated — take a side (against generic splits, against aesthetics-only training).

DON'T:

- Don't open slow (“hey guys, so today...”).
- Don't read a script off the screen.
- Don't go monotone or low-energy.
- Don't look at your own image instead of the lens.
- Don't try to be a polished influencer — be the real founder-athlete.
- Don't restart the whole take over one flubbed word.
- Don't be vague or “balanced” — vague content converts nobody.

3.4 · B-Roll & Visuals — Show, Don't Just Tell

Talking-head alone is fine, but the pieces that travel *show* something. B-roll (supplementary footage cut over the talking) does three jobs: it holds attention (visual change every few seconds), it hides edit cuts, and — most importantly for us — it delivers **product proof**. “Show, don't just tell” is not a style choice here; it's how we prove a cold audience that the app is real.

WHAT TO GRAB (A STANDING SHOT LIST TO COLLECT WHENEVER POSSIBLE)

- **Training clips of Ian:** sprints, plyometrics, court/pitch work, lifts. Shoot these in 4K/60fps so editing can slow-mo the explosive moments. This is proof for pillar 3 (“treniram kot športnik”) and endlessly reusable B-roll.
- **App screen-recordings (the highest-value B-roll we have):** record the phone screen showing the ATHLOS app *working* — the Coach generating a real plan, the daily report, biometrija, the season calendar. This is the product-proof that turns “cool idea” into “I want that.” Capture clean screen-recordings deliberately, not as an afterthought.
- **Tim / science footage:** Tim explaining or demonstrating a protocol, whiteboard/diagram moments, anything that visually signals real expertise (pillar 2).
- **Sport footage / atmosphere:** the pitch, the court, the gym filling up, a ball, cleats, the environment. Establishes the world and covers cuts.
- **Hands / detail shots:** lacing boots, chalking up, tapping through the app on a phone. Detail shots make an edit feel produced.

THE PRODUCT-PROOF RULE

Every time we make a claim about the app (“it knows your sport,” “it periodizes around your season,” “it adapts”), we should have footage of the app **doing exactly that** to cut over the claim. Capturing product-proof screen-recordings is a standing task, not a one-off — build a small library of them so any editor can pull the right clip. A claim over a shot of the feature working is worth ten claims over a talking head.

3.5 • The Content Day / Batching SOP

This is the operational heart of the founder-as-face model. Ian’s scarcest resource is on-camera time — he’s also building the app. So we do **not** film daily. We batch: **one Content Day per week, produce 5–10 pieces in one session.** Set up once, dress once, get into camera-energy once, and walk out with a week-plus of content. This is the direct answer to the solo-founder time blind spot.

Iman lens: the Content Day is Iman’s explicit beginner system — batch-film in one focused block, let the team handle the rest. We run it as a literal repeatable SOP so it survives Ian being busy.

STEP-BY-STEP SOP

PHASE A — Prep (team does this BEFORE the day; Ian just approves)

1. **Build the shot list.** The team assembles a numbered list of the 5–10 pieces to film: each with its hook line (Slovenian, written out), the 3 beats, the pillar it serves (JOURNEY / science / training), the CTA, and the intended format (vertical short vs horizontal long). Ian reviews it the day before — his only prep job.
2. **Group by setup.** Reorder the shot list so all pieces sharing a background/outfit/location are filmed back-to-back. Filming order follows *setup*, not topic — never tear down and rebuild a setup mid-day.
3. **Plan outfits.** Ian brings 2–3 different tops (and swaps mid-day) so batch-filmed pieces don't all look identical when posted across a week — otherwise viewers notice it was all shot in one session. Keep each outfit consistent within its block.
4. **Confirm locations & timing.** Book the gym/court for a quiet window. If outdoors is on the list, check the weather and slot it when light is good.
5. **Charge and clear.** Phone charged, storage cleared (enough free space for 4K), mic batteries charged, backup power ready.

PHASE B — Setup (team, ~15 min at the start of the session)

6. **Rig the shot.** Tripod at eye height, framing per §3.2 (grid, thirds, headroom), background set with depth, light in front of Ian, mic clipped on.
7. **Lock settings.** 4K/30 (or /60 for training), grid on, exposure + focus locked on Ian's face.
8. **Audio + framing test.** Record 5 seconds, play it back — check the audio is clean and the framing is right. Do NOT skip this. Discovering bad audio *after* a 3-hour session is a catastrophe.

PHASE C — Filming (Ian on, team runs it)

9. **Warm up.** First one or two clips are throwaways to get Ian into camera-energy. Don't publish clip #1.
10. **Film in setup-blocks.** Work through the shot list in order. For each piece: team reads the number and hook, Ian delivers, team confirms it's usable (or calls a retake), then moves to the next. Ian never manages the list — the team does; Ian just performs.
11. **Grab the B-roll (§3.4)** while everything is already set up — training clips, app screen-recordings, detail shots. Never leave a session without B-roll.
12. **Slate lightly.** Team notes which take is the keeper for each numbered piece (a quick note, or Ian claps/says the number) so editing isn't hunting through 40 clips.

PHASE D — File handling & handoff (team, immediately after)

13. **Back up first, immediately.** Offload all footage from the phone to two places (cloud + a drive) *before* clearing the phone. Never delete originals until the backup is verified. Losing a Content Day to a full phone or a lost file is unacceptable.
14. **Organize into a folder** named by date, e.g. `2026-07-11-content-day/`, with subfolders `talking-head/`, `b-roll/`, `app-screens/`. Match clips to the shot-list numbers.
15. **Hand off to editing** with the shot list attached — each piece’s number, hook, keeper-take note, format, caption direction, and CTA. Editing should never have to guess intent.
16. **Log it** on the content calendar: what was shot, what it becomes, when each piece publishes across the coming week(s).

The output of one Content Day: 5–10 talking-head pieces + a batch of B-roll + app-proof clips → enough for a week-plus of posting, all handed to editing in a clean folder. That is the entire founder-time cost of a week of content: one session.

3.6 · Editing & Packaging

Editing turns raw footage into scroll-stopping pieces; packaging decides whether anyone sees them at all. Per the Iman lens, **packaging is ~80% of the outcome** — so we treat the thumb-nail and title as more important than the edit itself.

THE EDITING STYLE (SHORT-FORM, SLOVENIAN)

- **Fast pace, no dead air.** Cut every pause, “umm,” and breath. Short-form should feel a touch faster than comfortable. If a moment isn’t earning its place, cut it.
- **Captions / subtitles are MANDATORY** for Slovenian short-form. Most people watch on mute; without burned-in Slovenian captions, the piece is dead on arrival. Auto-generate then **hand-correct** — auto-captions butcher Slovenian, and wrong subtitles look careless. Style them big, bold, high-contrast, one or two words highlighted as spoken.
- **Hook on screen in the first second.** Put the hook as text on screen immediately, backing up the spoken hook — it stops the scroll for muted viewers.
- **B-roll cutaways every few seconds** (§3.4) — cut to training, app screens, detail shots over the talking. Visual change holds attention and hides edit cuts.
- **Keep it tight.** For short-form, shorter usually wins — cut to the shortest version that still lands the point and the CTA.

THE TOOLS

- **CapCut** for short-form — fast, mobile or desktop, good auto-captions (still hand-correct the Slovenian), easy for the team to run without a pro editor. This is the default.

- **Premiere / DaVinci Resolve** for the long-form / VSL — the core converting video deserves a proper edit. Optional; CapCut can carry the whole operation at cold-start scale.

PACKAGING = 80%

For anything with a thumbnail (YouTube long-form, some Reels covers), the thumbnail and title do most of the work. Two disciplines:

Thumbnail — the Rule of Three (Iman: thumbnail is engineering, not art — optimize for click-through, ignore “pretty”). A strong thumbnail has exactly three elements:

1. **Ian’s face with a genuine, readable emotion** (intense, surprised, determined).
2. **Big, readable text** — 3–5 words max, legible on a phone screen.
3. **One context visual** — the app on screen, a training moment, a “vs” comparison.

Title discipline: decide the title + thumbnail *before* filming (Iman’s hard-won lesson — package first, shoot second), so the piece is built to deliver on the packaging. Specific and curiosity-driven, never generic.

Three example SL title + thumbnail concepts:

1. **Title:** *“Zakaj te ‘klasičen split’ dela POČASNEJŠEGA (nogomet)”* **Thumbnail:** Ian mid-sprint, intense face · text “POČASNEJŠI?” · small inset of a crossed-out Instagram workout split.
2. **Title:** *“Zgradil sem AI trenerja za slovenske športnike. Poglej, kako dela.”* **Thumbnail:** Ian holding the phone toward camera, app plan visible on screen · text “AI TRENER” · gym behind him.
3. **Title:** *“30 dni treniram po svoji aplikaciji. Teden 1.”* **Thumbnail:** Ian mid-plyo jump, determined · text “DAN 1 → 30” · the ATHLOS report visible as the context visual.

ONE LONG-FORM → MANY SHORTS

The long-form (or VSL) is the mother asset. Because it was shot horizontal in 4K with room around Ian (§3.2), editing crops it to vertical and pulls out the self-contained moments — a strong hook, a punchy science point, a proof moment — as standalone shorts.

Cold-start honesty: per `00-START-HERE.md`, we do NOT run the full 10-shorts-from-one-video remix engine yet — nobody’s watching enough for the math to matter, and it’s editing time we don’t have. We cut the **genuinely good** moments into a handful of shorts and ignore the quota. The remix engine is a month-2+ scaling lever once there’s an audience and a back-catalog (Iman’s “Content Rehashing” — noted, not used at launch).

3.7 · The Founder-as-Face Guardrail

This is the line that makes the whole system work. Draw it explicitly so nobody blurs it.

ONLY IAN CAN DO:

- **Be on camera** — his face, his presence, his energy. This is un-delegable. It's the entire trust engine (01-brand-foundation.md §3 : the person IS the moat).
- **Be the voice** — the opinions, the takes, the founder story, THE JOURNEY. The point of view is Ian's; it can't be ghost-performed.
- **Show up to the Content Day and perform** — deliver the hooks, do the retakes, grab the training B-roll.
- **Approve the shot list** the day before (his one prep task) and, ultimately, own that the content sounds like *him*.

That's it. That is Ian's entire job in this pipeline.

THE TEAM DOES EVERYTHING ELSE:

- Builds and researches the shot list and hooks (§3.5 Phase A).
- Owns all the kit, setup, framing, lighting, audio rig, phone settings (§3.1–3.2).
- Runs the Content Day — reads hooks, calls retakes, manages the list, tracks keeper-takes (§3.5 Phase C).
- Handles all files: backup, organization, handoff (§3.5 Phase D).
- Does all editing, captioning, B-roll cutaways (§3.6).
- Does all packaging — thumbnails, titles, the Rule of Three (§3.6).
- Schedules, posts, and tracks everything on the content calendar.

The design principle: every task that *can* be lifted off Ian, *is* lifted off Ian — so his scarce on-camera time is the only thing he spends on marketing. The more the team absorbs, the more content Ian can be the face of without it eating the time he needs to ship the app.

BLIND-SPOT CHECK — THE SOLO-FOUNDER TIME TRAP

The honest risk: at cold-start we may not have a full team yet, and some of “the team does everything else” lands back on Ian by default. **Batching is the mitigation.** By compressing all of Ian's on-camera time into one weekly Content Day, we cap his marketing time-cost to a single predictable block — even if he's temporarily also doing some editing. As the team fills in (per 09-team-marketing-protocol.md), each pipeline task moves off Ian in priority order: first the

file-handling and scheduling, then editing/captions, then packaging, then shot-list research — until Ian's only job really is *show up on Content Day and be the face*. That is the target state, and this chapter is the spec for reaching it.

One-sentence version: *Ian films one focused Content Day a week and is the face and the voice; the team builds, shoots-around, edits, packages, and posts everything else — and batching is what keeps the founder's time-cost to that single weekly block.*

4 • Distribution & Social Presence

This chapter is the operating manual for where ATHLOS shows up in public and how attention gets routed from a stranger's feed into a confirmed waitlist lead. Everything here inherits from `01-brand-foundation.md` (dual-brand architecture) and `04-funnel-sales-system.md` (the no-leak funnel). If anything here contradicts those, they win.

The one rule that governs this whole chapter: attention flows **Ian** → **@athlos** → **waitlist**, one direction, never backward. Ian's face and story pull strangers in; he *points* them at the app account and the free plan. The app account never has to be charismatic — it only has to be credible and easy to opt into. We do not run two content machines. We run **one founder, one camera, one funnel**, cross-posted intelligently.

Cold-start honesty (the blind-spot check runs through every section): we have a tiny starting audience, a solo-ish team also shipping the app, €0 ad budget, and a ~2.1M-person Slovenian market where the serious-athlete niche is tens of thousands, not millions. Iman's distribution playbook assumes 30+ feeder accounts and a paid clipper army. **We have Ian and one Content Day a week.** So wherever Iman says "scale the machine," we read it as "pick the two moves that a founder can actually sustain, and do those relentlessly." Volume targets in this chapter have a **floor** (what must happen even on a bad week) and a **stretch** (what a good week looks like). Build to the floor; treat the stretch as upside.

4.1 Platform roles — who does what, and the interlock

Every platform and every account has exactly ONE job. This is Iman's **Content Siloing** applied honestly at cold-start scale: we don't split effort evenly across a dozen surfaces, we assign each surface a single purpose so nothing is diluted and Ian always knows *why* he's posting a given thing.

THE ACCOUNT MAP

Surface	Account	Single job	Voice
Instagram (Ian)	personal — the priority, ~80% of effort	Trust engine. Daily founder presence, THE JOURNEY, the face people follow.	First person, human, opinionated — “jaz”
Instagram (@athlos)	app — lean, ~20%	Proof-and-offer repository. Tim’s science, product demos, the counter, testimonials, the offer. The place Ian <i>sends</i> people.	Brand/product — “mi” + Tim’s authority
YouTube long-form (Ian)	personal	The deep converter. The one “core video” (VSL) + occasional long build-in-public. Lives under Ian because the buyer must trust the founder-athlete before the app.	Ian, unhurried, in-depth
YouTube Shorts	Ian’s channel	Reach + a searchable back-catalog that compounds. Same clips as Reels.	Same as Reels
TikTok (optional)	Ian	Pure cross-post overflow. Zero extra production. Post the same vertical clip if it takes 30 seconds; skip it on a busy week without guilt.	Same as Reels

Why Instagram + YouTube are primary and TikTok is optional: IG is where the Slovenian 16–26 athlete audience actually lives and where a person (not a logo) gets followed. YouTube is where the *converting* long-form lives and where **search** works in our favor for years (a Short titled “hitrejši v nogometu” keeps getting found long after we post it). TikTok’s Slovenian discovery is real but thinner for this niche and the algorithm won’t reward a cold account fast enough to justify dedicated production in 30 days — so it’s a free cross-post, never a third machine.

THE PERSONAL ↔ APP INTERLOCK (THE HAND-OFF MOVES)

This is the load-bearing part of the whole chapter. Attention that lands on Ian is worthless unless it moves to the app account and then to the waitlist. These are the **exact mechanical hand-offs** that move it. Use them deliberately — every one of them is a place a lead leaks if it’s missing.

1. **The spoken outro (Ian → waitlist).** Every long-form and most Reels end with Ian saying it out loud, not just captioning it. Signature line, used verbatim every time so it compounds recognition (Ian's **signature style** motif):

"Gradim ATHLOS — link je v biografiji. Prvih 100 zaklene ceno za vedno." Spoken > written: people skip captions, they don't skip the last spoken line if the video earned the watch.

2. **The pinned comment (every post, both accounts).** The first comment is pinned by the poster and is *always* the same click-path — the free-plan opt-in, never a bare "check my app." On Ian's posts it reads as a gift; on @athlos it reads as the offer. See the first-comment formula in §4.3.
3. **Instagram Collab posts (Ian x @athlos).** When Ian posts a piece that features the product or Tim, publish it as an **IG Collab** so it appears natively on *both* grids and both audiences' feeds from one upload. This is the single cheapest way to seed the @athlos account without running it as a separate machine — Ian's reach carries the app account's early growth.
4. **Story chains (Ian → @athlos → link).** Ian's Story is the daily bridge. A chain runs: Story 1 = the human moment/hook → Story 2 = "poglej, kaj sem danes zgradil" pointing at @athlos → Story 3 = the **link sticker** to the opt-in. Ian **@-mentions @athlos** in the chain so a tap moves the viewer onto the app account's profile. Re-share @athlos's proof/testimonial posts to Ian's Story so the app account borrows Ian's audience.
5. **Link-in-bio (the one destination).** Both bios point to the **same** opt-in page (the free 7-day Tim plan → Beehiiv). Not a link tree with ten options — **one link, one decision**. Ian's bio: soft, "delam na tem." @athlos bio: hard, "prvih 100." Both buttons, same page. Every extra link on that page is a leak.

The interlock in one line: *Ian earns the attention → the spoken outro + Story chain + @-mention move it to @athlos → the pinned comment + link-in-bio move it to the waitlist.* If a piece of content has none of these hand-offs, it's a pure nurture piece for the core (fine — but know it, per Ian's **Intentional Brand**: map the click-path before you film, or don't film it).

4.2 Posting cadence — a realistic founder-led schedule

Honesty first: **one person also building an app cannot sustain a 30-account content operation.** The cadence below is what a solo founder with one Content Day a week can actually hold. Everything is expressed as **floor / stretch**. Hit the floor on a bad week and you're fine. The floor is designed so the funnel never goes dark, not so the algorithm is maximally fed.

WEEKLY CADENCE PER SURFACE

Surface	Account	Floor (bad week)	Stretch (good week)	Source
IG Reels	Ian	3 / week	5 / week	Content Day clips
IG Stories	Ian	daily, 1 chain	daily, 2–3 chains	Phone, raw, THE JOURNEY
IG feed (non-Reel)	Ian	1 / week	2 / week	Carousel or photo
IG Reels	@athlos	2 / week	3 / week	Same clips, Collab where product/Tim
IG Stories	@athlos	2 / week	daily re-shares	Re-share Ian + counter updates
YT long-form	Ian	0 most weeks	1 (the VSL, once)	Content Day
YT Shorts	Ian	3 / week	5 / week	Same clips as Reels
TikTok	Ian	0 (optional)	3 / week	Cross-post overflow
Beehiiv email	—	1 / week minimum	2 / week in launch window	See 04 §4

The non-negotiable floor (if literally nothing else happens in a week):

- **Daily Ian Story** (the funnel's heartbeat — this *is* the DM/engagement surface).
- **3 Reels + 3 Shorts** from one Content Day (same clips, two platforms).
- **1 Beehiiv email to the warm list.** The list is the launch; it must never go a week dark.

Read the cadence honestly against Iman: Iman posts to 30+ feeders daily because he has a team. We are running **one Content Day per week** that produces the raw material for everything above, plus daily phone Stories that cost minutes. If Ian ever feels the schedule pulling him off building the app, the correct move is to drop to the floor — never to skip the email or the Stories, which are where the money is; drop the *reach* posts (extra Reels, TikTok), never the *nurture* channel.

THE WEEKLY RHYTHM (WHAT A NORMAL WEEK LOOKS LIKE)

- **Mon — Content Day.** Batch-film. One long-ish talk-to-camera (or the VSL when it's VSL week) + 3–5 short setups. Good audio + clean background beats fancy gear (Iman's rule). This one day feeds the whole week.
 - **Tue–Fri — post + engage.** Reels/Shorts drop from Monday's batch; daily Stories from the phone; **the daily engagement ritual (§4.5) runs every day regardless of whether anything was posted.**
 - **One evening — write & send the Beehiiv email.** Founder voice, from Ian.
 - **Sat/Sun — light or off.** A Story or two. Rest is allowed; the machine survives a quiet weekend.
-

4.3 The short-form engine — one Content Day → ~8–10 clips everywhere

This is the production heart. Iman's principle: **you are building assets, not running on a treadmill.** One filming session becomes a week of distribution. Here is the exact flow.

FROM ONE CONTENT DAY TO THE FEED

1. **Film once (Monday).** In one session Ian shoots one longer talk-to-camera piece (5–12 min — the “core” idea of the week) plus 3–5 standalone short setups (a hook + one point each). Raw phone footage is fine; the standard is *clarity and energy*, not production polish.
2. **Cut to ~8–10 vertical clips.** From the long piece, pull the 3–5 strongest self-contained moments (a myth busted, a number, a before/after, a hot take). Add the 3–5 standalone shorts. That's **~8–10 clips from one day.**
3. **Route the clips** (this is the honest cold-start version of Iman's remix engine — post the clips that are *genuinely good*, don't force the full 10x math when nobody's watching enough yet):
 - **Best 3–5 → Ian's IG Reels** across the week.
 - **Same clips → Ian's YouTube Shorts** (identical file, but a search-optimized title — see §4.4).
 - **1–2 product/Tim clips → @athlos as IG Collab** (appears on both grids from one upload).
 - **Overflow → TikTok** if it's a 30-second cross-post, skip otherwise.
 - **The long piece → YouTube long-form** only on VSL weeks or when it's genuinely a standalone build-in-public episode; otherwise it's just clip fuel.

4. **Every clip carries the three hand-off elements:** on-screen hook (first frame), spoken outro, pinned first-comment CTA.

Do NOT re-edit per platform. Same vertical clip, same subtitles, different *title/caption* per platform. Re-editing is the treadmill; re-titling is the asset move. (Post-launch, when a back-catalog exists, this is exactly where Iman's **Content Rehashing** kicks in — new title/thumbnail on an old clip to unlock latent reach at ~zero cost. Note it now; it becomes the #1 anti-burnout lever in month 2, not week 1.)

THE CAPTION FORMULA (SLOVENIAN) — USED ON EVERY CLIP

A caption is not a description, it's a **second hook + a reason to act**. Structure, top to bottom:

[HOOK LINE — one punchy sentence that restates the video's promise]

[1–3 SHORT VALUE LINES — the takeaway, so even a non-watcher learns something]

[CTA LINE — always the same click-path, pointing at the pinned comment/bio]

[3–5 niche hashtags — see §4.4]

Drop-in example (a speed/explosiveness clip):

Tvoj “klasičen split” iz Instagrama te dela POČASNEJŠEGA. 🧵

Nogomet in košarka ne potrebujeta bicepsov za pozo — potrebujeta eksplozivnost, hitrost spremembe smeri in moč, ki se prenese na igrišče. Generični program tega ne da.

Napisal sem ti brezplačen 7-dnevni Timov načrt za tvoj šport → **link v prvem komentarju**. Prvih 100 zaklene ceno za vedno.

#nogomet #košarka #hitrost #eksplozivnost #športnitrening

ON-SCREEN HOOKS (THE FIRST FRAME)

The first frame decides watch-through, and watch-through decides reach (Iman: **packaging is 80%**). Rules:

- **Text on the very first frame**, big and readable on a phone, high contrast, safe from the UI overlay.
- It states a **specific, sport-named** promise or provokes, e.g. *”Zakaj si počasnejši, čeprav treniraš več”, ”To dela vsak slovenski nogometaš narobe”, ”Postal sem hitrejši v 3 tednih — tukaj je kako”*.

- Name the **enemy** where possible (generic bodybuilding splits) — it's the sharpest hook we have and it's ownable.
- **Never** a vague hook ("moji nasveti za trening"). Specific + sport-named beats clever every time in a small market.

THE FIRST-COMMENT CTA (PINNED, EVERY POST)

Pin the first comment yourself the moment you post. It's the click-path that IG's link-suppression on captions can't kill. Formula:

📌 Brezplačen 7-dnevni načrt za tvoj šport (Tim Drenovc) — link v biografiji. Napiši mi, kateri šport treniraš, in ti povem, kje začeti.

That last line — *"napiši mi, kateri šport treniraš"* — is deliberate: it invites a comment (which boosts the post) **and** opens a DM-qualification thread (§4.5). The comment is a funnel entrance, not an afterthought.

4.4 Discovery / SEO — being found by searching athletes in a tiny market

We have no ad budget and a small audience, so **being findable** is disproportionately valuable — a searchable clip keeps working for years. Iman calls this **minefield / search farming**: durable, low-view, high-intent content that compounds. In a 2.1M market, a Short that ranks for "hitrejši v nogometu" doesn't need a million views — it needs the few hundred *right* Slovenian athletes who search that exact thing every year.

YOUTUBE (WHERE SEARCH ACTUALLY PAYS)

Treat YouTube as a search engine, not a feed. For **every Short and every long-form**:

- **Title = the exact query an athlete would type**, in Slovenian, front-loaded with the keyword:
 - Shorts: *"Kako postati hitrejši za nogomet (brez teka na dolge proge)", "Košarka: skočnost v 6 tednih", "Zakaj te split dela počasnega"*.
 - Long-form / VSL: *"ATHLOS — kako trenirati kot profesionalni športnik (slovenski sistem)"*.
- **Description = the search-farmed body**. First two lines repeat the keyword and the promise (that's what shows in search). Then a short paragraph in natural Slovenian using the athlete's own words (from the ICP pains: *"ne vem, ali sploh treniram pravilno", "nihče ne trenira specifično za moj šport"*). End with the **link to the opt-in** and the offer line.

- **Tags:** nogomet trening, košarka trening, hitrost, eksplozivnost, skočnost, sprint, atletska priprava, športna priprava slovenija, kondicijski trening, Tim Drenovc, ATHLOS.
- **Consistent titling convention** so the channel reads as *the* Slovenian athletic-performance library — the thing that shows up when a coach or athlete searches in Slovenian and finds nothing else serious.

INSTAGRAM (KEYWORDS > HASHTAGS NOW, BUT USE BOTH)

IG search increasingly reads **captions and on-screen text as keywords**, so:

- Put the real query **in the caption and on-screen text** in plain Slovenian (“hitrost”, “eksplozivnost”, “priprava na sezono”, “nogomet”, “košarka”) — not just in hashtags.
- **Hashtags (3–5, niche not broad):** #nogomet #košarka #slovenskišport #hitrost #eksplozivnost #športnitrening #kondicija #atletskapriprava. Avoid mega-tags like #fitness (2 billion posts, we drown). A tag with tens of thousands of Slovenian posts is where our athlete actually browses.
- **Geo + club language:** name Slovenian places and the sport’s own vocabulary (“za slovenske nogometaše”, “pred sezono”, “na igrišču”) so the algorithm and human search both file us under the right, small, high-intent bucket.

THE SEARCH-FARMING MINDSET (BLIND-SPOT HONESTY)

We are **not** chasing virality — the market is too small and the buyer too specific for a viral hit to convert well (a motivational video with 200K views from Serbia and Croatia sells zero €59 Slovenian subscriptions). We are planting **durable, sport-specific, Slovenian-language answers** to questions our exact buyer types into a search bar. That’s the reach lever that survives a founder who can only post a few times a week: it keeps working while Ian builds the app.

4.5 Community & DMs — the daily ritual that IS the funnel

At our scale, **engagement is not “support the content” — engagement is the sales team.** Iman automates because he has volume; we do the opposite (per 04 §0): we go **manual where it converts**. At tens-to-low-hundreds of leads, a personal DM out-converts any automated flow. This is Ian’s unfair advantage — he can talk to *every single lead* by hand. A big operator can’t.

THE DAILY ENGAGEMENT RITUAL (30–45 MIN, EVERY DAY, POSTED OR NOT)

Run this every day regardless of whether content went out:

1. **Reply to every comment. Every one.** No exceptions while the audience is small. A reply is free reach, a warmth signal, and often a DM opener. Ask a question back where natural (turns a comment into a thread).
2. **Reply to every DM and every Story reply personally.** No autoresponders. Ian, as himself.
3. **Go outbound, 15 min:** engage genuinely on the posts of Slovenian nogomet/košarka athletes, club pages, and the accounts our ICP already follows (§4.6). Real comments, not “🔥”. This is how a cold account gets discovered by the right people — you show up in their world first.
4. **Log warm threads.** Any athlete who replies, comments meaningfully, or opts in → into the Hot/Warm/Cold spreadsheet (from `00-START-HERE.md` lever #1). These are the humans Ian DMs at launch.

THE DM-QUALIFICATION MOVE (PULL A NEW FOLLOWER/COMMENTER → WAITLIST)

When someone new comments, replies to a Story, or follows after a good post, Ian opens a **short, human, non-salesy** thread whose only goal is to hand them the free plan and get an email. Never a wall of text, never a pitch. The move:

Opener (after they comment/follow):

Ej, hvala za komentar! 🙌 Kateri šport treniraš?

They answer (e.g. “nogomet”):

Top. Ravno delam brezplačen 7-dnevni načrt za nogometaše — hitrost + eksplozivnost, napisal ga je Tim (fiziolog). Ti ga pošljem?

They say yes:

Super — vpiši se tukaj [link], da ti ga pošljem takoj: [opt-in]. In povej, kje te trening zdaj najbolj ustavlja — mogoče ti lahko pomagam že prej.

If they engage but don’t opt in: don’t push. Give one piece of genuine free value in the DM (a single cue for their sport), leave the door open. A helped athlete opts in later; a pitched one blocks you. (This is Iman’s **disqualification** instinct inverted for warmth — we filter tire-kickers by *not* chasing, and we make the serious ones feel personally coached.)

TURNING FOLLOWERS INTO FANS (PARASOCIAL TRUST)

- **Consistency of face + signature line** (the spoken outro) builds recognition — same person, same promise, every time.
- **Use their words back to them.** When Ian names the exact pain an athlete DM'd him ("ne veš, ali treniraš pravilno") in the next Reel, that athlete becomes a fan — they feel *seen*.
- **Founding-member framing in every interaction:** the early people aren't customers-to-be, they're *the first 100*, the believers who were here before it was public. Say it. It converts followers into evangelists who bring their locker room (§4.6).

4.6 Cross-promotion & free distribution — the only paid channel is other people's audiences

We have €0 for ads. So our "media budget" is **other people's trust**: Tim's audience, Slovenian athletes and clubs, other creators, podcasts, and UGC from real users. Iman buys distribution with a clipper army; we *earn* it with collabs and value. This is the highest-ROI growth work available at cold start — one post from a trusted local face outperforms weeks of Ian's cold Reels.

THE FREE-DISTRIBUTION LEVERS, IN PRIORITY ORDER

1. **Tim's audience (highest ROI, do this first).** Tim is the science face and has athletes/clients/followers who already trust him. One post/Story from Tim — "*delam na tem, dobi zgodnji dostop + brezplačen načrt*" — is worth more than 20 of Ian's cold Reels (per 04 §2.4). **Lock a minimum Tim content commitment in writing** (this is flagged as a top launch risk in 00-START-HERE.md): how many minutes/month on camera, and at least one launch-window post to his own audience. Tim as **proof, not promoter** — a short, credible "this is right," not a hype reel.
2. **Slovenian athletes & clubs (collabs + seeding).** Micro-collabs with individual club/academy nogomet & košarka athletes, especially any in Ian's warm graph:
 - **IG Collab Reels** with a local athlete doing a Tim drill → hits both audiences from one post.
 - **Give the app free** to 3–5 credible local athletes in exchange for an honest Story/testimonial as results come in (this also feeds the social-proof engine and the launch emails). Real athlete + real result = the most persuasive content we can make.
 - **Value into club/team group chats and Slovenian FB/Discord communities Ian legitimately belongs to** — drop the free 7-day plan *as value, not spam*. A team sport shares within a locker room naturally; one well-placed drop in a Slovenian nogomet group can out-perform a week of cold Reels.

3. **Other Slovenian creators (co-marketing).** Non-competing adjacent creators — physio/health, sport nutrition, a local strength coach, a football-content creator. Trade a guest appearance, a co-made Reel, or a mutual shout. Each borrows a warm audience for free. Study *their* over-performing formats and reskin them for our niche (Iman: **study other niches, don't copy competitors**).
4. **Podcasts & appearances.** Slovenian sport, fitness, startup, and youth-athlete podcasts / YouTube shows. Ian's angle — *"the founder-athlete building Slovenia's first AI training system, testing it on himself"* — is a genuinely interesting guest story (build-in-public + local + AI). One good 45-minute podcast puts Ian in front of a whole warm audience with high trust transfer, and yields clip fuel for weeks. Pitch 5–10; land 1–2 in the 30 days.
5. **UGC from real users (organic, unpaid).** As founding members get results, make it *easy and rewarding* to share: a founding-member badge, a "postal sem hitrejši z ATHLOS" prompt, a re-share of anything they post. Wire the **Beehiiv referral loop** ("deli s soigralcem → oba dobita bonus protokol") so the locker-room shares happen inside the funnel. This is the honest, unpaid version of Iman's paid-clipper distribution: our users become our clippers because the product actually helped them.

BLIND-SPOT CHECK ON CROSS-PROMOTION

- **Small market cuts both ways.** Everyone knows everyone — a fake testimonial or a spammy group drop is *permanent* trust death here. Every collab must be genuine, every seeded plan a real gift. Our credibility is the entire currency (from 01 \$5).
- **Don't wait for a big audience to start collabs.** Collabs are how a cold account gets its *first* audience — do them in week 1, not "once I'm bigger." Ian's warm graph (lever #1 in 00) is the seed list for both leads *and* collab partners.
- **Guard the founder's time.** Tim's post, one podcast, and 3–5 athlete seedings will out-produce any amount of extra solo posting. If Ian has two free hours, they go into *one* good collab, not two more Reels.

Chapter summary — the distribution machine in one page

- **One founder, one camera, one funnel.** Ian is the face (~80% effort); @athlos is a lean proof/offer repository (~20%); short-form is shot once and routed everywhere.
- **The interlock is the point:** spoken outro + pinned comment + IG Collab + Story chain + one link-in-bio move attention **Ian** → **@athlos** → **waitlist**, never backward.
- **Cadence has a floor:** daily Ian Story + 3 Reels/3 Shorts from one Content Day + 1 weekly Beehiiv email — the funnel never goes dark; everything above the floor is upside.

- **One Content Day** → ~8–10 clips, re-titled per platform (not re-edited), each carrying an on-screen hook, a spoken outro, and a pinned first-comment CTA — all in native Slovenian.
- **We optimize for being *found* by the right few, not for virality:** search-farmed YouTube titles/descriptions/tags and niche Slovenian IG keywords, because a searchable clip compounds for years while Ian builds the app.
- **Engagement is the sales team:** reply to every comment and DM, run the daily ritual, and use the DM-qualification move to hand new followers the free plan by hand — Ian's unfair advantage over any big operator.
- **Our only “ad budget” is other people's trust:** Tim's audience first, then Slovenian athletes/clubs, other creators, podcasts, and real-user UGC — earned, genuine, and started in week 1.

5 • The Funnels & The Backend Machine

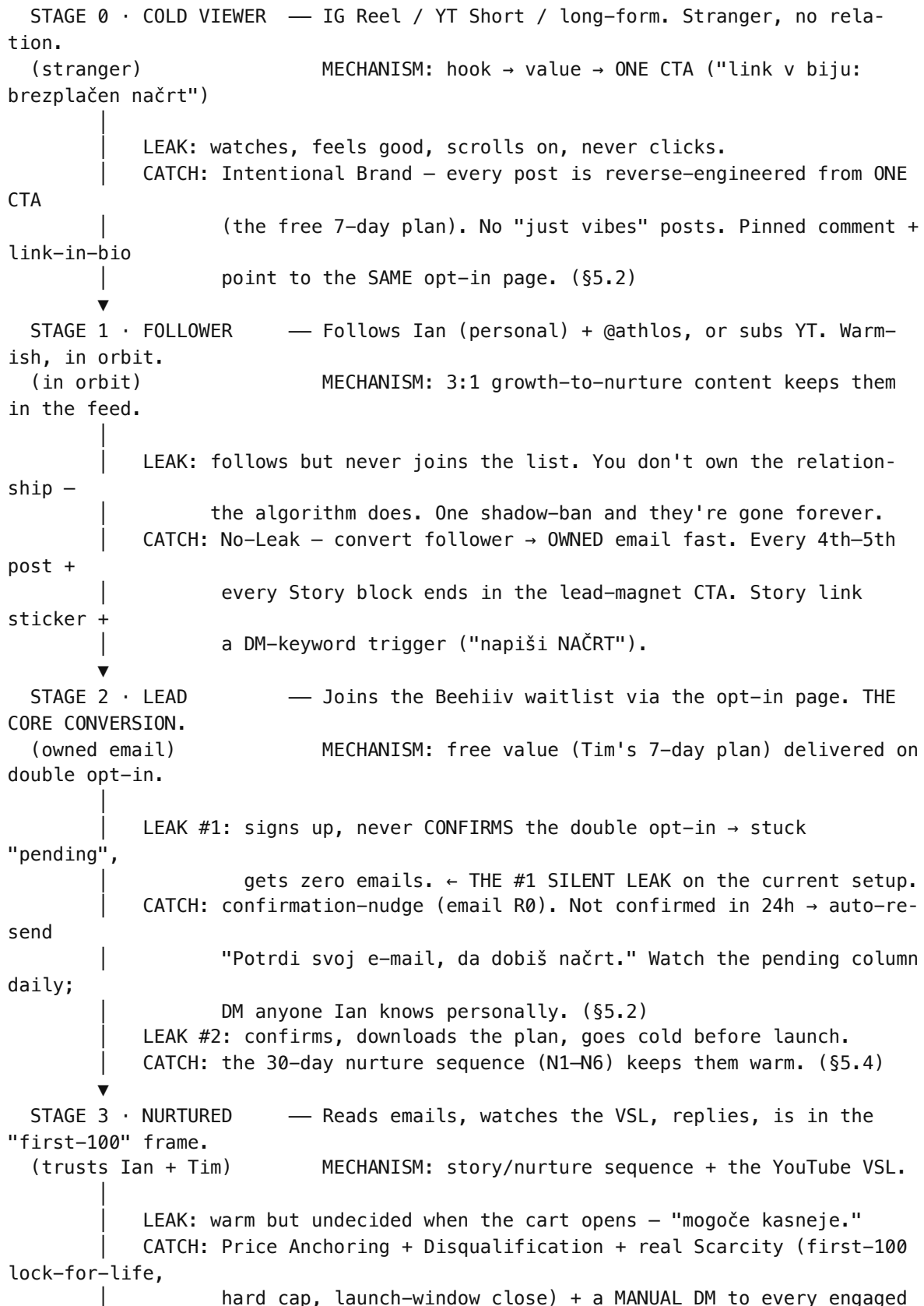
This chapter turns everything upstream — Ian's face, the content, Tim's science — into money. Content is the top of the funnel; **the funnel is where the business actually lives**. Iman's word for this is the **No-Leak Backend**: at every stage a qualified lead can slip out, and a system must be there to catch it. His whole philosophy is that follower count doesn't pay — *leads that convert and stay subscribed* do. So this is the least glamorous chapter in the manual and the most load-bearing one.

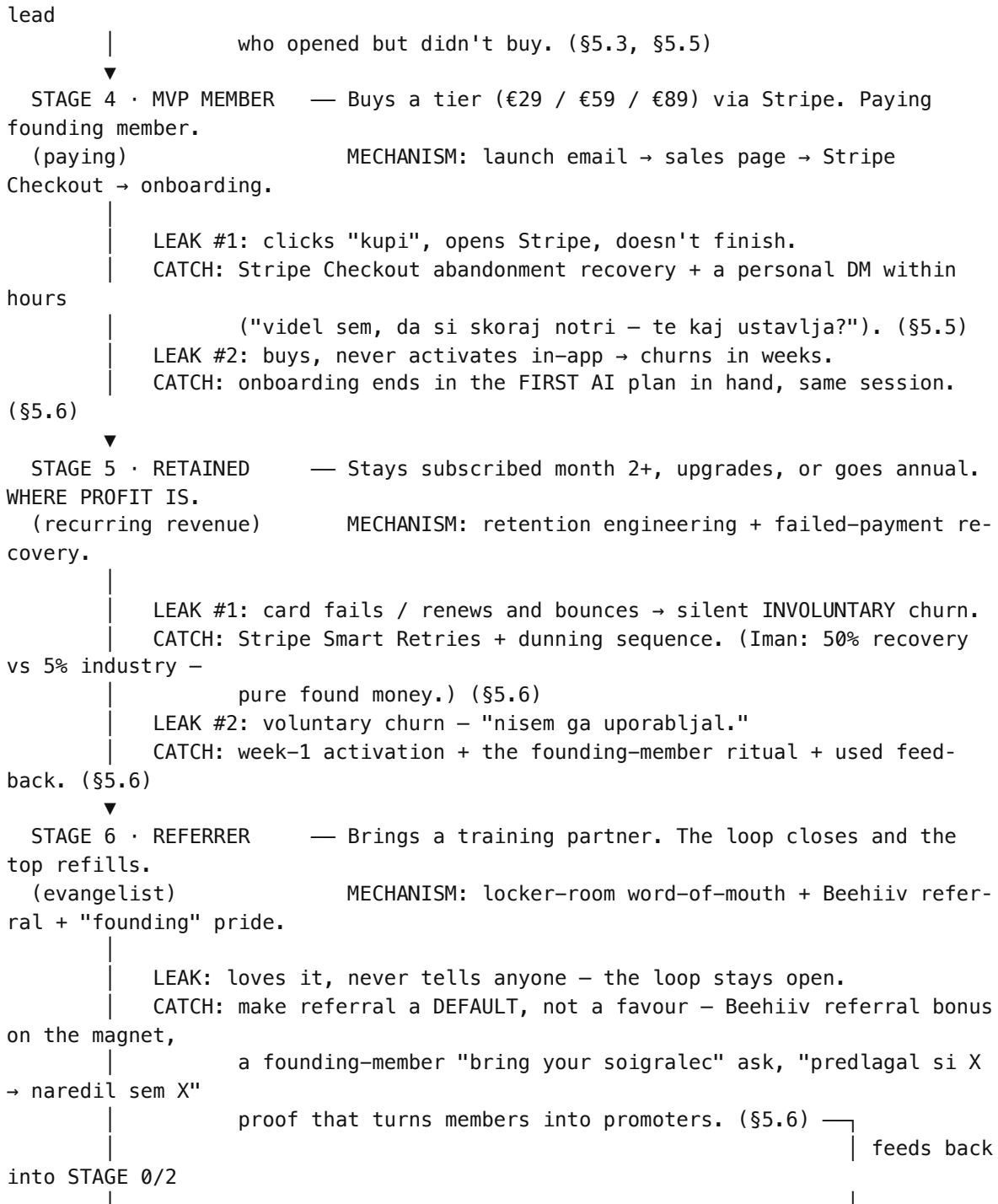
Read it with the cold-start lens on the whole time. Iman pours millions of monthly views into the top of his funnel, so he automates everything and lets the volume do the work. **We do the opposite**. Our top is a trickle, not a firehose. That's not a weakness here — it's the unfair advantage: at 80–200 leads, Ian can personally touch *every single one*. The rule for this whole chapter is: **automate the plumbing, close by hand**.

This chapter maps and connects. It does **not** rewrite the assets. The finished Slovenian opt-in copy, the 13 emails, the pricing copy, the dunning emails all already exist in `04-funnel-sales-system.md`, `07-lead-magnet-tim-7day.md`, and `08-launch-email-sequence.md`. Here we show how the pieces lock together and in what order to build them.

5.1 The full funnel map — where every lead leaks, and what catches it

Seven stages. A stranger becomes a viewer, a viewer becomes a follower, a follower becomes an owned lead, a lead gets nurtured, a nurtured lead buys, a buyer is retained, and a retained member refers. **At every arrow, someone leaks**. The job of the backend is one thing: make sure that at our tiny volume, *not one of the 5–20 buyers we can realistically get* falls through a gap nobody was watching.





The whole machine in one sentence: content points at ONE free plan → the plan converts a follower into an owned email → 30 days of Slovenian nurture + a founder VSL build trust → a hard-capped first-100 early-bird cart opens → Stripe checkout with manual DM backup → acti-

vation + dunning keep the subscription alive → happy founders refer their locker room and refill the top. **No step relies on volume Ian doesn't have. Every step relies on a leak-catcher one human can still run by hand.**

5.2 Lead capture — the magnet, the opt-in page, and where the CTA lives

THE LEAD MAGNET IS A SLICE OF THE PRODUCT, NOT A FREEBIE

A “waitlist” that only promises “get notified at launch” is a dead magnet — “get notified” is a chore, not a benefit. The opt-in must hand over something valuable the instant someone joins. Ours is already built (see `07-lead-magnet-tim-7day.md`):

“**7-dnevni ATHLOS Starter**” — a real, usable 7-day speed/explosiveness micro-protocol authored by Tim Drenovc, delivered as a clean PDF, plus a 60-second self-assessment (“Kje si zdaj?”) that tells the athlete which phase they’re in.

Why this specific magnet works (Iman’s **documentation-before-education** applied honestly): it’s *one real week of the actual product*, not a generic PDF. It proves ATHLOS’s core value — personalized, Tim-verified training — before anyone pays a cent. It’s near-zero marginal cost (the Coach brain generates the sport-specific base). And the assessment writes a **segmentation tag** (per-sport, per-level) we reuse in nurture. Iman would build a 5-day livestream with a \$250K prize pool here; the right-sized cold-start equivalent is one PDF one person can ship.

THE OPT-IN PAGE + WAITLIST MECHANICS (BEEHIIV DOUBLE OPT-IN)

The finished Slovenian opt-in copy lives in `04 §2.5` — do not rewrite it. Mechanically, the page does exactly three jobs:

1. **Names the free thing as a product**, not a notification (“Dobi svoj 7-dnevni načrt. Brezplačno.”).
2. **Captures sport + email** — the sport dropdown is what makes segmentation possible.
3. **Teases the first-100** at the bottom (“Med prvih 100, ki vstopijo, zaklene ceno za vedno.”) — this seeds §5.3 before the price is ever named.

The one thing everyone building this must understand about Beehiiv: **double opt-in is ON, which means the biggest silent leak in the entire funnel lives right here.** A sign-up that never clicks the confirmation email is stuck “pending” and receives *nothing* — not the plan, not the nurture, not the launch. That person raised their hand and we lost them to a checkbox. So:

- **Email R0** (04 §4a) auto-resends the confirmation if not confirmed in 24h (“Manjka samo en klik”).
- The Google Sheet logs pending vs confirmed — **someone watches that column daily** and manually DMs anyone Ian knows personally. At this scale, one recovered pending lead can be one buyer.

WHERE THE CTA LIVES (ONE DESTINATION, EVERYWHERE)

The Intentional-Brand rule: every surface points to the **same** opt-in page. No competing links.

Surface	The CTA
IG / YT bio (Ian + @athlos)	Link-in-bio → opt-in page
Every Reel / Short	Spoken + on-screen “link v biju: brezplačen 7-dnevni načrt”
Pinned comment (every post)	Same opt-in link
IG Stories	Link sticker + DM-keyword trigger (“napiši NAČRT”)
The VSL description	Same opt-in link
Tim’s post / story	Same opt-in link (his audience is the highest-ROI source)
Every DM Ian sends by hand	”pošlji mi šport, dam ti načrt” → opt-in link

5.3 The value ladder & the offer

Iman’s ladder ascends from a low-ticket front-end to high-ticket. Ours is a **subscription-only B2C ladder** — simpler, and correct for this market. Four rungs, locked (from 00-START-HERE.md and 04 §3):

RUNG 0 · FREE	7-dnevni Starter + assessment (the magnet). Job: prove value, capture email, segment by sport.
▼	
RUNG 1 · WAITLIST	Free membership. "Founding member" frame. Job: own the relationship, nurture, promise the early-bird.
▼	
RUNG 2 · EARLY-BIRD MVP (the launch)	First 100 lock lifetime pricing: BASIC ~€49~ €29/mes · PRO ★ ~€99~ €59/mes · ELITE ~€149~ €89/mes
▼	
RUNG 3 · RETENTION / ANNUAL	Stay subscribed / upgrade tier / go annual (2 meseca gratis). Job: recurring profit – where subscription money actually is.

Price anchoring — two anchors, never a bare price. Every tier shows against its crossed-out regular price (~€49~ €29/mes). But the *stronger* anchor is the human-alternative one, and it should be the hero of the pricing section:

Kaj to nadomesti: Osebni trener + kineziolog + fizioterapevt = €200–500+ / mesec v Sloveniji. ATHLOS: cel sistem, 24/7, od €29 / mesec.

That reframes €29 against a €200–500 real-world stack — it makes the price feel almost free, and it is the ATHLOS thesis (“every athlete deserves the strokovna ekipa, as an AI system”).

Disqualification (Iman’s positioning move, adapted). We don’t disqualify by income like Iman — we disqualify by *seriousness*. The copy (“ATHLOS ni za tiste, ki iščejo bližnjico...”, 00 / 04 §3.2) makes the athletes who *do* fit feel chosen and filters out low-fit, high-churn buyers before they cost support time. **Tier steering:** PRO (€59) is the visual “priporočeno” middle — BASIC anchors low, ELITE (€89, waitlist-only) anchors high and flatters PRO into the sane choice.

Real scarcity, never fake. Hard cap at 100. A counter that actually decrements. In a market this small, one faked count is permanent trust death — round milestones (“že 34 od 100”) are fine, invented urgency is not. The lock-for-life is the honest reason to act *now*.

5.4 The email / nurture engine

Three sequences, **13 emails**, all in Beehiiv, all from “Ilan iz ATHLOS-a” with reply-to a real inbox Ilan reads — **replies are the goal**, they’re the warmest close signal at this scale. The full Slovenian copy already exists (re-engagement + nurture in 04 §4a/§4b); the 5 launch emails as

drop-in broadcasts in 08). This section is the **send logic**, not the copy.

SEQUENCE A · RE-ENGAGEMENT (wake the existing ~12) — Beehiiv AUTOMATION, week 1

R0 → only to `pending`: confirm → get the plan [fixes the #1 silent leak]

R1 → "Hvala, ker si bil zraven od začetka" + the gift

R2 → "Zakaj sem začel graditi ATHLOS" + a question that begs a reply

SEQUENCE B · NURTURE / 30-DAY STORY (whole list) — Beehiiv AUTOMATION, ~1 email / 4–5 days

N1 → welcome, deliver the magnet (instant on confirm)

N2 → the problem, named (Problem Farming) – pure value, no pitch

N3 → the expert: who is Tim, why Ian trusts him (trust transfer)

N4 → build-in-public: the app is real + FIRST LINK TO THE VSL

N5 → the €200–500 alternative it replaces (plants the price anchor before price exists)

N6 → first-100 heads-up + disqualification + "odgovori JAZ za opomnik" (builds the DM list)

SEQUENCE C · LAUNCH (cart open → close) — Beehiiv manual BROADCASTS, 5–7 day window

L1 → CART OPEN (warm list first, first-access checkout)

L2 → handle the #1 objection ("ali deluje za MOJ šport?")

L3 → founder story / why now (the nurture spike, 3:1)

L4 → scarcity, real remaining count

L5 → FINAL CALL / cart closes (lock-for-life delta, hard close)

The send logic that matters:

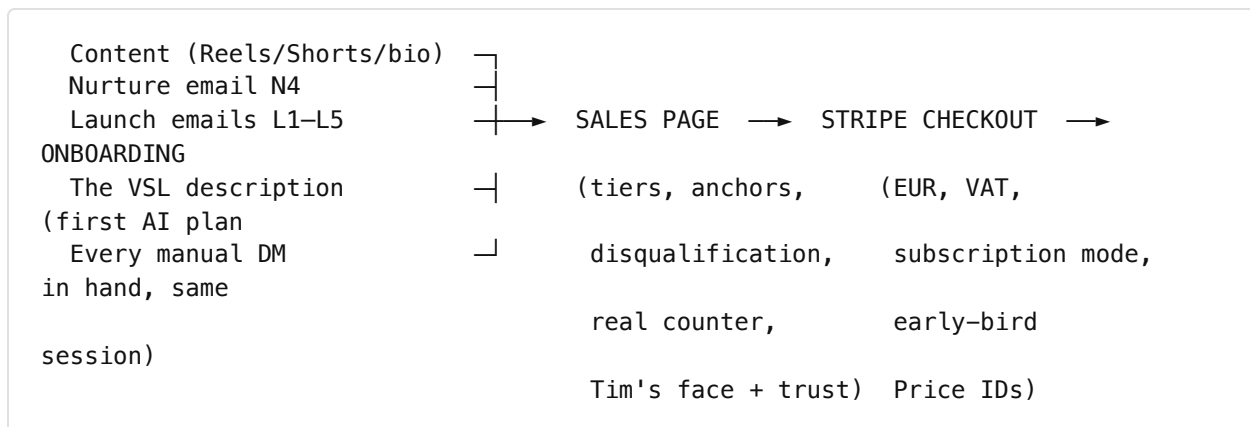
- **A and B are automations; C is manual broadcasts.** Re-engagement and nurture fire on triggers (confirm, time-delay) and run themselves. The launch is 5 manual broadcasts because a launch needs *live control* — a real counter, a real close time you announce and honour.
- **The trigger boundary:** R0 is segmented to `pending` only. N1 fires the instant someone confirms. C is sent to the confirmed warm list first (they got first-access framing in N6), then public.
- **Never duplicate across sequences.** A confirmed early sub gets R1/R2 (welcome-back), *then* rejoins the N-flow — don't send them the "here's your first plan" welcome twice. Segment by `confirmed_date` so old subs and new subs don't collide.
- **Manual DMs run in parallel to every launch email** (§5.5). The email is the announcement; the DM is the close. At ~100–200 leads, 5 launch emails + personal DMs beat 12 automated emails. **Depth of touch > breadth of sequence** — this is the deliberate cold-start inversion of Iman's heavily-automated 10-email launches.

- **A/B in Beehiiv:** use the built-in subject-line test on each launch broadcast (Subject = A, alternate = B, keep preview text identical), send the winner by open rate.

5.5 The core converting flow — everything routes to one Stripe checkout

VSL + CONTENT + EMAILS → ONE CHECKOUT

The VSL (one honest 8–15 min founder-to-camera video: *why generic training fails* → *the strokovna-ekipa idea* → *Tim's system* → *the app working live* → *the offer*) is the **gravity center** every other asset links to. Its job at launch is **not** to be found by strangers — it's to be the trust-and-convert asset Ian links in **N4, L1, every bio, every DM**. It converts the traffic Ian already routes to it; post-launch, as the channel grows, it becomes the evergreen Flywheel VSL Iman describes. (We can shortcut Iman's "make 15–30 videos first to find the topic" — the topic is already known: it's the launch pitch itself.)



THE CHECKOUT UX (NO-LEAK = MINIMAL FRICTION)

`/api/checkout` + `src/lib/stripe.ts` are built and launch-gated (503 until `LAUNCH_MODE=live`). The rules:

- **One page, one decision.** Tiers and checkout in the same flow. Every extra click is a leak.
- **Stripe Checkout, not a custom form.** Fewer failure modes, Apple/Google Pay built in, mobile-first by default, minimal fields (email + card — nothing we don't need). This is a **Slovenian phone-first audience**; the checkout has to feel like two taps.
- **The first-100 counter stays visible and honest** through the flow.
- **Trust signals on the page:** Tim's face + credentials, "prekliči kadarkoli," GDPR/zasebnost link, the real counter.

- **Early-bird Price IDs.** The €29/59/89 are locked to dedicated launch Price IDs so the first-100 price grandfathers for life at the Stripe level — a pricing setup, not a promise on a page.

CART-ABANDONMENT + FAILED-PAYMENT RECOVERY

- **Stripe Checkout abandonment recovery** — auto-emails anyone who entered checkout and didn't finish, with a link back to the same session. Turn it on before launch.
- **The manual killer move (Ian's unfair advantage):** the launch list is small enough that Ian **personally DMs anyone who clicked-but-didn't-buy within a few hours** — *"Videl sem, da si skoraj vstopil — te kaj ustavlja? Vprašaj karkoli."* At this volume a human "je vse ok?" recovers more carts than any automation. A big operator literally cannot do this; Ian can talk to every lead.
- **Failed-payment dunning** (Smart Retries + the Slovenian dunning emails) is set up here but *runs* in §5.6, because for a subscription the first failed charge is a retention event, not a checkout event.

5.6 Retention & referral — where a subscription actually makes money

MVP is a subscription, so **month-1 retention decides whether the business is real**. A €29 buyer who churns after 30 days is a loss after Stripe fees. Iman's own framing: retention beats acquisition, and failed-payment recovery is the most under-worked profit lever there is.

ACTIVATION IS RETENTION (THE FIRST 10 MINUTES)

The single strongest churn-prevention lever is: *did they use it in week 1?* So **onboarding must end in a generated AI plan in hand, not an empty dashboard** — activation = first workout plan, same session they paid. Then a **Day-2 check-in email** (`Kako gre s prvim tednom?`, reply invited) catches confusion before it becomes a cancel.

THE FOUNDING-MEMBER RITUAL (RETENTION ENGINEERING, RIGHT-SIZED)

Iman time-gates unlocks (coaching calls unlock month 2, etc.) to build churn-prevention into the product. Ian's cold-start version:

- **Founding-100 identity + perks over time:** price locked for life (the core hook) + a "founding member" badge + "the next feature ships *for you first*." A reason to still be here in month 2.

- **A weekly Tim value email to paying members** (separate from the marketing list) — keeps perceived value high between app sessions. Cheap, compounding.
- **Ask founders for feedback and USE it visibly.** “Predlagal si X → naredil sem X” is the most powerful retention move a founder-led MVP has — and it’s the exact mechanism that converts a member into a **referrer**.

FAILED-PAYMENT DUNNING (PURE FOUND MONEY)

Involuntary churn (expired/declined cards) is silent and large. Iman’s most quotable stat: **50% recovery vs 5% industry**. Set up on day 1 of billing:

- **Stripe Smart Retries** — auto-retries failed charges on an optimized schedule.
- **Dunning emails** (Slovenian, from 04 §6.3): fail day 0 → `Plačilo ni šlo skozi (2 klika)` · retry day 3 → `Še vedno ne gre – dostop se čez X dni zapre` · final → `Zadnji poskus – obnovi, da ne izgubiš founding cene`.
- **The lock-for-life price is the retention weapon:** “če odideš, izgubiš €29 za vedno — nova cena je €49.” Staying becomes rational, not emotional.
- **Card-updater / expiry reminders** before renewal to pre-empt the failure entirely.

TURNING THE FIRST MEMBERS INTO A REFERRAL LOOP (STAGE 6 → REFILLS THE TOP)

Team-sport athletes share inside a locker room by default — we just have to make referral the path of least resistance, not a favour to ask:

- **Beehiiv native referral on the magnet:** “Deli s soigralcem → oba dobita bonus protokol.” The free tier spreads inside a team chat on its own.
- **The founding-member “bring your soigralec” ask:** once a member is activated and happy (post Day-2 check-in), the moment to ask for one referral — a founder who feels chosen brings a teammate.
- **Visible used-feedback as social proof:** “predlagal si X → naredil sem X” posted publicly turns one happy founder into evangelism the whole warm graph sees. This is the loop closing: a referrer sends a stranger back to Stage 0/2, and the funnel refills without new cold reach.

5.7 The build order — stand the funnel up in the right sequence

Build inside-out: **plug the leaks before you pour anything in**. A lead captured before the plumbing is watertight is a lead lost.

PHASE 1 · PLUMBING (days 1–5) – before any list-growth push

- [] Confirm the lead magnet (Tim's 7-day PDF + assessment) is finished & downloadable (07)
- [] Rewrite/verify the opt-in page copy + sport dropdown (04 §2.5)
- [] Build Beehiiv Sequence A (re-engagement, incl. R0 pending-nudge) as an AUTOMATION (04 §4a)
- [] Build Beehiiv Sequence B (nurture N1–N6) as an AUTOMATION with the confirm trigger (04 §4b)
- [] Clean the pending pile – check the Google Sheet `status` column, fire R0 (§5.2)
- [] Set up segmentation tags (sport, confirmed_date) so sequences don't collide

PHASE 2 · CHECKOUT & MONEY PLUMBING (days 5–15, in parallel with list growth)

- [] Create the early-bird Stripe Price IDs (BASIC/PRO/ELITE) so first-100 grandfathers (§5.3, §5.5)
- [] Wire the sales page: tiers, both anchors, disqualification, real counter, trust (§5.3)
- [] Enable Stripe Checkout abandonment recovery (§5.5)
- [] Set up dunning: Smart Retries + the 3 Slovenian dunning emails (§5.6)
- [] Confirm onboarding ends in a generated AI plan (activation) (§5.6)
- [] Keep /api/checkout gated at 503 until LAUNCH_MODE=live

PHASE 3 · CONVERT ASSETS (days 15–25)

- [] Record + publish the VSL (8–15 min); link it in N4, every bio, the sales page (§5.5)
- [] Load Sequence C (L1–L5) as manual broadcasts, ready to send (08)
- [] Build the "JAZ" reply list from N6 → the manual-DM close list (§5.4)

PHASE 4 · LAUNCH (days 26–30)

- [] Flip LAUNCH_MODE=live; open the cart to the warm list first (§5.5)
- [] Send L1–L5 over a 5–7 day window; keep the counter honest
- [] Run manual DMs in parallel – close every engaged lead + every clicker by hand (§5.5)
- [] Watch confirmed leads / counter / conversion – NOT view counts (04 §7)

PHASE 5 · POST-LAUNCH (day 31+)

- [] Day-2 check-in email to every buyer; verify week-1 activation (§5.6)
- [] Start the weekly Tim member email; ship one used-feedback item visibly (§5.6)

[] Turn on Beehiiv referral on the magnet; make the "bring your soigralec" ask (\$5.6)

Sequencing rule: never open the cart (Phase 4) before the dunning and abandonment plumbing (Phase 2) exists — the first failed payment will happen in week 1, and a subscription that can't recover a bounced card leaks profit from day one.

Blind-spot check

- **This funnel is real, but the top is a trickle.** With ~12 warm subs and a cold audience, the launch does **not** live or die on new cold traffic in 30 days. It lives on (a) waking the warm list, (b) converting Ian's own network + DMs by hand, and (c) whatever content adds on top. If you build the beautiful funnel and forget to *manually message every human*, you built the wrong thing. Cold content seeds month 2–6; it does not carry launch day.
- **Automation is a trap at this scale — except for the plumbing.** Iman automates because volume justifies it. At a dozen-to-few-hundred leads, a personal DM outconverts any automated email. Automate the Beehiiv sequences, Stripe, and dunning; **close by hand**. The day this funnel gets big enough to *need* full automation is a good day — we are not there, and pretending we are would cost buyers.
- **Sober numbers.** Grow the warm list to a realistic 80–200 leads and a good warm launch converts 5–12% → **~5–20 paying founding members in month 1**. That is a *success* for a solo organic cold-start, not a failure. The real asset built here is a warm, segmented Slovenian athlete list + a watertight checkout/retention machine + the first 5–10 testimonials. Do not measure any of this against Iman's launch screenshots — his one public financial data point showed insolvency. Measure it against the counter and the confirmed-leads number.
- **The #1 silent leak is the double opt-in, and it's invisible.** A pending sub looks like nothing on a dashboard — no bounce, no complaint, just silence. If nobody watches the `pending` column daily, the funnel will quietly lose its best-intent leads and no one will know why the numbers are soft. This is the leak most likely to go unnoticed, so it gets the most explicit human check.
- **Retention beats acquisition, and it's the part a founder in launch-adrenaline forgets.** The temptation is to pour all energy into the cart open and none into Day-2 activation and dunning. But for a subscription, a churned €29 buyer is a *loss*. The founding-member ritual, the week-1 check-in, and the dunning emails are not "later" — they are Phase 2 and Phase 5 on purpose.

6 · How The Team Runs It — The Operating System

This chapter is the team's **operating system**: how a small, founder-led team actually runs the ATHLOS marketing machine, week to week, from zero. Not a RACI lecture — a working manual. If you're on this team, this is the chapter you re-read every Monday.

The one line that governs everything below: Ian is the face; the team is the machine around the face. The whole system is engineered so Ian's only non-delegable jobs are (1) being on camera and (2) the handful of calls only a founder can make. Everything else, the team absorbs.

Cold-start honesty (read once, remember always): we are a solo-ish team also shipping the app, with a tiny warm list, organic-only, in a ~30-day window. This is *not* Iman's 30-person content factory. Every role below is a hat, not a headcount — the same person often wears two. We design the OS to survive that reality, not to pretend it away.

6.1 The founder-as-face principle (for the team)

Iman's core structural move — "**effortless front, best-in-class backend**" — is the spine of how we operate. The public sees Ian: relaxed, on camera, building ATHLOS in the open. What the public never sees is the team running the unglamorous machine that turns Ian's face into leads, leads into founding members, and members into retained revenue. The gap between how effortless it looks and how systematic it actually is — *that gap is the moat*.

For that to work, we protect Ian's time like it's the scarcest resource in the company. Because it is. Ian is simultaneously the on-camera talent **and** one of the two engineers shipping the app. If the team leaks work onto Ian that the team could have absorbed, the app slips or the content dies — and both are fatal.

WHAT ONLY IAN CAN DO (NEVER DELEGATE THESE)

1. **Be on camera.** Ian is THE FACE. He films THE JOURNEY, he presents the science with Tim, he trains himself on the product on camera, he records the VSL, he goes live on launch day. Nobody else can be the founder-athlete. This is his #1 job and the one input the whole machine depends on.

2. **Own the network + the DMs.** The launch lives on Ian's warm graph (his athletes, coaches, training partners) and on personal replies. At this scale a founder's DM outconverts any automation. Ian personally messages the people he knows and personally replies to every lead who raises a hand. The team can *tee up* DMs (draft, list, remind) but the send comes from Ian, in his voice.
3. **Hold the vision + the taste calls.** Positioning, the offer, what ATHLOS stands for and against, whether a piece of content is "us" or not, the disqualification line, the honesty of the scarcity counter. These are founder judgment calls. The team executes them; Ian sets them.
4. **The few founder-only decisions:** launch date, price, whether to go live, what promise we can honestly make ("za vedno"), and any call that touches trust in a small market where one wrong move is permanent.

WHAT THE TEAM ABSORBS (SO IAN NEVER TOUCHES IT)

Everything else. Editing, packaging (titles/thumbnails/captions), scheduling, posting, the @ath-los account, Beehiiv setup and sends, the Stripe plumbing, the dashboard, abandonment and dunning, the lead-magnet generator, checkout and onboarding, launch ops, the numbers. Ian should walk into a Content Day, film, walk out — and the finished, packaged, scheduled content, plus every backend system it feeds, appears without him lifting another finger.

The test for every task: *"Does this require Ian's face, Ian's network, or Ian's founder judgment?"* If **no**, the team owns it end-to-end and does not put it back on Ian. If **yes**, get Ian the minimum viable input (film this, approve this, send this) and absorb everything around it.

Blind-spot check: the failure mode here is the team quietly becoming a "please approve this" queue that turns Ian into a bottleneck. If Ian is approving more than a short daily batch, the team has under-absorbed. Default to shipping within the locked brand rules and showing Ian the result, not asking permission for every piece. Approval is for the few founder-only calls, not for a caption.

6.2 The roles (practical, not seat-theater)

Five people, plus Tim. These are **hats**, sized to a cold-start team — one person may hold two, and that's expected. What matters is that every job below has exactly one owner, so nothing falls in the gap between "someone should" and "nobody did."

IAN — FACE / NETWORK / VISION

- On camera for all content (THE JOURNEY, science-with-Tim, training-himself, VSL, launch live).

- Owns his personal account's voice and his network DMs + personal lead replies.
- Sets positioning, offer, taste, and makes the founder-only calls.
- **Also** wears an engineer hat on the app — which is exactly why his marketing surface is kept this tight.

THE 2 ENGINEERS — SHIP THE APP + BUILD THE MARKETING-CRITICAL PLUMBING

The app shipping on time is **the #1 marketing dependency**, full stop. No product on launch day = no launch, regardless of how good the content was. So the engineers' first and non-negotiable job is the MVP ship date. Their marketing-facing jobs, in priority order after that:

1. **The lead-magnet generator** — the tooling that turns Tim's brain into the sport-specific 7-day PDFs + the 60-second assessment (the Coach brain generates the base). This is what makes the free opt-in real.
2. **Checkout + onboarding** — Stripe early-bird price IDs, the launch gate (`LAUNCH_MODE`), and onboarding that ends in a *generated plan in hand the same session* (activation = retention).
3. **Product-proof capture** — the ability to screen-record the Coach generating a real plan, the report, biometrija — the raw material Ian's content and the VSL are built from.

One of the two engineers is Ian. Plan the engineering roadmap knowing Ian is also the face — protect the ship date by keeping his content load to Content Day + DMs, nothing more.

THE 2 MARKETERS — SPLIT INTO TWO CLEAN LANES

This is the heart of the team. Splitting them by lane (not by “we both do marketing”) is what makes the pipeline actually run.

(a) Creative / Content lead — owns the pipeline *after Ian films*.

- Editing, cutting Content Day footage into Reels/Shorts + the occasional long-form.
- **Packaging** — titles, thumbnails, captions, hooks in idiomatic Slovenian. (Ian: *packaging is 80%* — this lane carries most of the reach outcome.)
- Scheduling and posting on cadence.
- Runs the **@athlos account** as a lean proof-and-offer repository (~2x/week), and cross-posts the shared short-form.
- KPI they live by: content shipped on cadence + the one content-health number (6.5).

(b) Funnel / Ops / Data lead — owns the backend *where the money is caught*.

- **Beehiiv** — the list, segments, the re-engagement + nurture + launch sequences, the confirm-nudge (the #1 silent leak), deliverability.
- **Stripe** — early-bird price IDs, abandonment recovery, dunning/failed-payment recovery.
- **The dashboard** — owns the ~6 numbers, updates them, brings them to Monday.
- **Launch ops** — the go-live checklist, sequencing L1–L5, wiring the counter, coordinating the live moment.
- KPI they live by: no lead leaks, and the launch scoreboard.

TIM — SCIENCE CONTENT, LOCKED IN WRITING

Tim is **the proof, not the promoter**. His job is narrow and scarce on purpose (scarcity = authority): appear in Pillar-2 science content and product-proof cut-ins, co-sign the lead magnet, and ideally post/story once to his own athletes (“delam na tem — zgodnji dostop + brezplačen načrt,” the single highest-ROI growth move we have).

Lock this before Day 1: Tim’s minimum commitment in **minutes/week**, in writing. ~40% of the content strategy and 100% of the authority strategy structurally depend on him appearing. If he can’t commit, the Content lead builds the fallback where Ian carries the science co-signed “*kar sem se naučil od Tima*” — but we decide that up front, not mid-launch. An unsigned dependency under the whole plan is a top-two launch-killer.

6.3 THE CONTENT PIPELINE — the core of the team OS

This is the literal flow of **one piece of content** from idea to measured result, and exactly who touches it at each stage. Learn this flow; it’s what the team *is*. The design principle: **Ian appears at exactly one stage (filming). Everything before and after is the team.**

STAGE 1 – IDEA / PACKAGING FIRST OWNER: Creative lead
Decide the big idea + Slovenian title + thumbnail/hook BEFORE filming (Iman: packaging is 80%, decide it first). Pull from the pillar plan + problem-farming backlog. Ian signs off the batch in one pass.



STAGE 2 – CONTENT DAY (FILM) OWNER: Ian (+ Tim when needed)
One batch day/week. Ian films 3–5 pieces against the pre-approved packaging list. Good audio + clean background beats fancy gear. Tim films his science cut-ins in his locked minutes. THE ONLY STAGE THAT NEEDS IAN'S FACE.



STAGE 3 – EDIT OWNER: Creative lead
Cut Content Day raw into finished Reels/Shorts (+ long-form/VSL when scheduled). Ian does NOT edit. Product-proof screen-recordings (from the engineers) are dropped in here as B-roll.



STAGE 4 – PACKAGE / FINALIZE OWNER: Creative lead
Lock title, thumbnail, caption, on-screen text – all idiomatic Slovenian. EVERY piece carries ONE CTA to the lead magnet / offer (Intentional Brand – no "vibes-only" posts). Pinned comment + bio point to the SAME opt-in.



STAGE 5 – SCHEDULE + POST OWNER: Creative lead
Personal account = priority (~80%). Same short-form cross-posted to @athlos + YT Shorts. Daily "dan X/30" cadence. No firehose – one good piece/day beats three rushed ones.



STAGE 6 – ENGAGE OWNER: Ian (network/DMs) + Creative lead (public replies)
Ian personally answers DMs + high-intent comments (this IS funnel work). Creative lead handles routine public comments + routes hot leads to Ian. Every raised hand → the lead magnet / list.



STAGE 7 – MEASURE OWNER: Funnel/Data lead
Not views. Did the piece drive CONFIRMED LEADS? Feed the winner back

into Stage 1 (double down on what drove opt-ins). Log to dashboard.

Read the pipeline as a promise to Ian: *"You show up on Content Day, film against a list we already packaged, answer your own DMs — and a week of finished, scheduled, measured content appears. You never edit, never write a caption, never touch a scheduler."* If any stage other than 2 and (part of) 6 lands on Ian, the pipeline is broken and the Creative lead fixes it.

Blind-spot check: with a real back-catalog, Iman's team would also run a rehashing loop (repackage old winners, new thumbnail/title only) as Stage 8. **We have no catalog yet — skip it for launch.** Note it as the Creative lead's #1 anti-burnout lever for month 2+, don't build it now.

6.4 The weekly rhythm (keep meetings minimal)

The whole point of a tight OS is that the team spends its hours *building the machine*, not *sitting in meetings about the machine*. Four rhythms, that's it.

1. CONTENT DAY — THE ONE TENTPOLE (½–1 DAY, WEEKLY)

The single batch-film day. Creative lead arrives with the pre-approved packaging list (Stage 1 already done). Ian films 3–5 pieces; Tim films his cut-ins if it's a science week. This is the only recurring block that needs Ian's face and the whole team's coordination. **Protect it** — a missed Content Day = an empty content week = the funnel starves.

2. MONDAY NUMBERS REVIEW — LEADS NOT VIEWS (15 MIN, WEEKLY)

Short and disciplined. The Funnel/Data lead presents the ~6 numbers (6.5). One question drives it: **"Did we grow confirmed leads, and did nothing leak?"** Not "how did the Reel do." If the team ever spends this meeting celebrating view counts, it's off-mission — that's Iman's core discipline made into a standing rule. Decide the week's one focus, end the meeting.

3. ASYNC DAILY CHECK-IN (2 MIN, TEXT, NO MEETING)

A single message in the team channel: what shipped yesterday, what ships today, any blocker. No standup call. At this team size a live daily meeting is pure overhead. The only thing that must surface fast: **anything blocking the app ship date or a lead leaking** — those get escalated the moment they appear, not saved for Monday.

4. THE WEEK-4 LAUNCH PUSH (THE EXCEPTION TO “MINIMAL”)

Launch week breaks the calm rhythm on purpose. During the 5–7 day launch window: a short daily sync (go-live checklist, counter, which email drops today, who’s DMing whom), the live launch moment, and the Funnel lead watching the scoreboard in near-real-time. This is the one week the team runs hot. Everyone knows it’s coming and clears the decks for it.

Blind-spot check: the temptation is to add more meetings as launch nerves rise. Resist. More syncs ≠ more members. The launch is won by the manual DMs and the emails going out on time, not by talking about them. Keep even launch week to *one* short daily sync plus async.

6.5 The metrics & dashboard (the ~6 numbers)

Vanity metrics are **banned** from this team. Follower count, Reel views, YouTube subs — they feel like progress and correlate with nothing that pays. The dashboard is short on purpose (Iman: *optimize for leads, not views*). The Funnel/Data lead owns it, updates it, and brings it to the Monday review.

#	Metric	Why it’s on the board	Healthy signal (cold-start, 30d)
1	Confirmed leads (double-opt-in)	The only top-of-funnel number that pays	12 → 80–200 by launch
2	List growth rate (net new confirmed/week)	Is the machine actually filling the top?	Steady weekly climb, no flat weeks
3	Checkout completion (started → paid)	Catches the biggest launch-day leak	> 50% finish; the rest get DM’d
4	Founding members / 100	The launch scoreboard	5–20 = a win for solo organic
5	MRR (recurring, after Stripe fees)	Proof-of-model — is this real revenue?	Any positive, growing number
6	Content-health number — <i>leads driven per week by content</i> (not views)	Does the pipeline actually feed the funnel?	Content adds real opt-ins, however few

Who updates it, and when. The Funnel/Data lead updates the dashboard continuously (it's their standing job) and presents it every Monday in the 15-minute review. During launch week, numbers 3, 4, and 5 are watched daily. Ian sees the dashboard but does not maintain it — his relationship to the numbers is “am I on plan?”, not “let me update the sheet.”

Blind-spot check: #6 (content-health) is the one people will try to replace with “views” because views are bigger and feel better. Hold the line — a Reel with 4,000 views that drove zero opt-ins is a *failure*; a Short with 300 views that drove 6 confirmed leads is a *win*. That's the whole team's north star in one comparison.

6.6 THE GROUND-UP BUILD ROADMAP (from zero → launch in ~30 days)

Here's how the team builds the entire system from nothing, phased, mapped to the 30-day window. Each phase has a clear “done” bar. **The floor is sacred:** wake the list + hand out the free plan + plug the leaks + one honest VSL + five emails + DM every human. Everything above the floor is upside.

PHASE 0 — SETUP (ROUGHLY DAYS 1–3)

Stand up the stack and the brand kit so the machine has rails.

- **Accounts:** both bios live (Ian personal = priority, @athlos = proof/offer repo), Beehiiv workspace, Stripe account, the shared team channel + dashboard skeleton.
- **Stack wiring (engineers):** Stripe early-bird price IDs stubbed, `LAUNCH_MODE` gate in place, Beehiiv double-opt-in confirm-nudge configured (this fixes the #1 silent leak on Day 1).
- **Brand kit (Creative lead):** the Slovenian voice, the Hellenic visual look (kept as free differentiation), thumbnail/caption templates, the pillar plan + a starter problem-farming backlog.
- **Locks (Ian):** confirm the beachhead niche against the list's real sport mix; get Tim's minutes/week in writing.
- **✅ Done when:** a piece of content could be posted and a lead could opt in and land in a working (if empty) sequence — the rails exist end-to-end.

PHASE 1 — FIRST CONTENT DAY + LEAD MAGNET LIVE (ROUGHLY DAYS 4–10)

Turn on the two engines: content and the free offer.

- **Lead magnet (engineers + Tim):** the sport-specific 7-day PDFs + 60-second assessment generated and live behind the opt-in.

- **First Content Day (Ian + Creative lead):** the pipeline runs its first full loop (idea→film→edit→package→schedule→post). Daily “dan X/30” documentation begins.
- **Wake the list (Funnel lead + Ian):** re-engagement sequence R0/R1/R2 sent; Ian starts mining his network by hand (the biggest week-1 lever); Tim’s one post/story goes out.
-  **Done when:** the lead magnet is live and converting, THE JOURNEY is publicly running, the warm list is awake and getting the free plan, and net-new confirmed leads are climbing.

PHASE 2 — AUDIENCE + LIST GROWTH + THE VSL (ROUGHLY DAYS 11–24)

Grow the warm list and build the one convert asset.

- **List growth (whole team):** network DMs continue, Beehiiv referral loop live, daily content → link-in-bio, Slovenian sport-community value drops. Target trajectory toward 80–200 leads.
- **Nurture (Funnel lead):** N1–N6 running so leads arrive at cart-open warm and primed.
- **The VSL (Ian + Creative lead):** record ONE honest 8–15 min founder-to-camera core video (why generic training fails → the system → the app working → the offer). Ship it rough; it becomes the gravity center every email and DM links to.
- **Launch prep (Funnel lead):** Stripe early-bird IDs finalized, abandonment recovery + dunning wired, the “JAZ” heads-up reply list built.
-  **Done when:** the list is meaningfully bigger and warm, the VSL exists and is linkable, and every backend leak (confirm, checkout, abandonment, dunning) is plugged and tested.

PHASE 3 — LAUNCH (ROUGHLY DAYS 25–30)

Open the cart to the warm list first and catch every lead by hand.

- Flip `LAUNCH_MODE=live`; open to the warm Beehiiv list first (first crack at the 100).
- Run L1–L5 over a tight 5–7 day window; the live launch moment (IG/YT Live or launch-day Story series).
- **Manual close:** Ian personally DMs every clicker-who-didn’t-buy and every “JAZ.” This is the unfair advantage — at this scale a human “je vse ok?” recovers more carts than any automation.
- Funnel lead watches the scoreboard (checkout completion, members/100, MRR) daily.
-  **Done when:** cart has opened and closed on schedule, every lead was personally caught, and the team has its first founding members + first testimonials. → **Day 31+:** onboarding, retention, dunning, and turning the flywheel for month 2 (where the compounding actually lives).

Blind-spot check: the roadmap will feel like too much for a solo-ish team also shipping the app — because it is, if you try to do all of it perfectly. So the rule is: **if a week slips, protect the floor and cut from the top.** Skip the second content operation, skip the remix math, skip the mythology posts, skip a polished VSL. Never skip: the app ship date, waking the list, the free plan, one rough VSL, five emails, and DMing every human.

6.7 The 3 rules the team never breaks (+ the honest expectation)

Rule 1 — Protect the app ship date above all. The app shipping is the #1 marketing dependency; no product = no launch. Content and marketing serve the ship date, never the reverse. If marketing work is threatening the ship date, marketing yields — cut from the top of the roadmap (6.6), never from engineering.

Rule 2 — Leads, not views. Always. Every decision, every Monday review, every content call is judged by *confirmed leads and members*, not impressions. The moment anyone on the team is optimizing for a view count or celebrating a viral Reel that drove zero opt-ins, they're off-mission. This is the discipline the whole OS is built to enforce.

Rule 3 — Never fake it, never leak it. In a small market where everyone knows everyone, one whiff of a fake scarcity counter or a dishonest claim is permanent trust death. The “prvih 100 / za vedno” scarcity is real or it isn't used. And every lead is worth catching by hand — no confirmed lead leaks out of the funnel unnoticed, because at this volume every single one is a countable buyer.

THE HONEST EXPECTATION (THE TEAM INTERNALIZES THIS, OR MORALE DIES)

Plan emotionally for **~5 founding members** in month 1; be thrilled at 15. Confirmed leads of 40–150 by launch, ~8% converting, month-1 recurring revenue that is a **proof-of-model, not a salary**. The real asset the team builds is not the member count — it's the *warm, segmented list of right-fit Slovenian athletes + a working, leak-free checkout/retention machine + the first 5–10 testimonials*.

The failure mode is **not** “only got 8 members.” The failure mode is the team *feeling* like 8 is a flop and losing momentum before month 2, where the compounding lives. Do not measure this team against Iman's highlight reel — those numbers are marketing, and his one public financial data point showed insolvency. Measure against the floor: *did the machine get built, did the list get warm, did nothing leak, and can it run again next month without Ian burning out?* If yes, the team won.

Start this week

Do not try to build all six chapters at once. In order:

1. **Ch. 1.3** — stand up the two accounts, the bios, Beehiiv + Stripe, the content board.
2. **Ch. 3.5** — run the first Content Day: batch-film the first 5–10 videos from the Ch. 2.5 starter bank.
3. **Ch. 5.2** — put the free 7-day Tim plan live as the lead magnet + wake the warm list.
4. **Ch. 6.6** — follow the phased roadmap to launch.

Protect the app ship date. Be the face. Optimize for leads, not views.